泥鳋的士

An-an Lee

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失踪夜
Missing in the Night GM-01

The Ghost Master
鬼马探灵记

Missing in the Night
失踪夜

Hallway, Deep in the Night
深夜走廊

Treading lightly through the maze of candles and piled paper, the team moves with deliberate caution, their steps barely making a sound.
跨过蜡烛与纸堆，职员们小心翼翼，蹑手蹑脚。

Foundation Staff Member I: There's something off about this wind. It sounds creepy, like someone's heaving a sigh. Don't you think, Joshua? Aren't you scared?
圣洛夫基金会职员 I： 这阴风阵阵的，您不害怕吗？约书亚先生……

Foundation Staff Member II: You're joking, right? Joshua's one of the St. Pavlov Foundation's top investigators, William. I mean, after what happened at Green Lake, I thought everyone knew about him.
圣洛夫基金会职员 II： 你在开玩笑吗？威廉……他可是圣洛夫基金会里赫赫有名的调查员，我还以为自从绿湖事件以后，约书亚先生的名头早就传遍了。

Horropedia: Uhh. Let's try not to pigeonhole people, Millie. And why don't we keep that bit of info under our hats, eh?
恐怖通： 噢，我不喜欢给其他人留下刻板印象。留些悬念，米莉……还请别告诉他。

Horropedia: Once this investigation's wrapped up, that'll be the time for the lead to exit stage left.
恐怖通： 等这次调查圆满结束，才是主角的扮演人员弹出荧幕的时候。

He squats before the iron door and runs two fingers along the floor.
他在铁门前蹲下来，用手划过地面。

Horropedia: This dust is pretty built up. I'd say the disappearance happened much earlier than we originally thought.
恐怖通： 灰尘已经积了有一阵子……确切的失踪时间肯定比我们所知晓的更早一些。

Horropedia: And look at all these bills and advertising flyers.
恐怖通： 加上这些缴费单和宣传广告纸——

thwack
“咚”。

Horropedia: Hey! Jeez, that hurt! Who smacked my head?!
恐怖通： 嘶……噢，疼！谁在敲我脑袋——

The landlady, her hair a mass of curlers and a toothpick wedged between her teeth, is looming behind him with a rolled-up newspaper clutched in her hand.
打着烫发卷的包租婆，叼着牙签，手执卷起的报纸，站在身后。

Landlady: What do you think you're doing sneaking around my property? And you—yeah, you with the glasses! What's up with you, huh?
包租婆： 你们在我的楼里鬼鬼祟祟，想做些什么啊！尤其是你，四眼仔！

Landlady: Creeping around with those shifty little eyes ... Just you wait. I'll have the cops here before you can say "unlawful entry"!
包租婆：左望右望，偷偷摸摸——你信不信我分分钟叫阿 sir 过来！

Foundation Staff Member II: Ma'am, we've already informed the local police. We've got official permission to investigate this building.
圣洛夫基金会职员 II：女士，我们已经通知了本地的巡警，这次调查已经经由了许可。

Landlady: Investigate what?! There's nothing wrong with my building! And don't you even think about messing with my tenants, unless you're looking to get reported!
包租婆：你们来调查什么，我这栋楼好旺的，别来烦我 D 租户啊，否则我投诉你们啊！

Millie flashes the St. Pavlov Foundation's investigation permit.
她亮出了手里的圣洛夫基金会调查许可。

Landlady: "St. Pavlova Foundation"? What're you, some kind of Australian dessert police?
包租婆：“剩裸夫基金会”？

Foundation Staff Member II: We're currently looking into the disappearance of two members of the Paranormal Affairs Bureau.
圣洛夫基金会职员 II：我们正在调查鬼魂治理协会的两名成员的失踪案。

Foundation Staff Member II: Your tenant, Ms. An-an Lee, is one of our freelancers, though it's been a while since we last heard from her.
圣洛夫基金会职员 II：而李安安小姐，是我们的外聘职员，只是她与我们失联了有一段时日……

The landlady walks between them, doubt still coloring her face.
女人半信半疑地从她们之间穿过。

Landlady: This door's been broken for ages. You'll never get it open.
包租婆：这扇门坏好久了，关上就会锁死。

Landlady: But hey, she still hasn't paid the rent, so why should I bother getting someone in to fix it?
包租婆：但谁叫她到现在都还未交租啊，我也一直都没找人来修。所以……

Despite her warning, the door creaks open after a gentle touch.
本以为紧闭的门被她轻轻推开了。

Foundation Staff Member II: ...!
圣洛夫基金会职员 II：……！

The gum that was holding open the door lock drops to the floor.
一枚原本顶住门插哨的口香糖，掉落在地。

The landlady spits out her toothpick and struts smugly into the newly opened office.
女人吐掉牙签，得意地迈入了事务所。

Landlady: Hah, nice try. You wanna play, little girl? Let's play!
包租婆：哼，小把戏。同我玩……喇叭妹，你还早一万年啊。

The others go inside, but Horropedia remains by the doorway. He crouches down to take in the disarray around the entrance.
众人迈进了门口，但恐怖通却没有进去的意思，他只是蹲下了身子，环视着乱糟糟的门口。

Foundation Staff Member II: Joshua?
圣洛夫基金会职员 II：约书亚先生？

She follows his gaze until her eyes land on the floor. Among the crumpled newspapers and scattered flyers, a single piece of white paper catches her eye.
职员跟着他的视线，将目光聚焦到了门口的地面上。那堆零散的报纸与五颜六色的小卡片之间，有张白纸格外显眼。

Horropedia: What time is it now?
恐怖通：现在已经几点了？

Millie shrugs and glances at her watch.
职员耸了耸肩。

Foundation Staff Member II: Almost midnight. Any new orders from the Foundation?
圣洛夫基金会职员 II：马上就要凌晨十二点了。您是收到基金会新的指令了吗？

Horropedia: No. We need to go. We need to go now! We're running out of time!
恐怖通：不……该走了，我们该走了，时间恐怕马上就要来不及了，我们必须现在马上赶过去！

Finally, the significance of that white sheet of paper dawns on the two Foundation members.
两名基金会成员的目光终于定睛在了那张白纸上。

Foundation Staff Members: ...?!
众成员：?!

Landlady: Well? What are you all standing there for? Come in already! I didn't go through all this trouble for nothing!
包租婆：喂，你们还站在门口干什么？你们不是要进来吗？枉我费力气啊！

Landlady: Hold on a second. You're not leaving just like that! If she's on your payroll, you need to pay me her rent!
包租婆：还有嘞……你们别想就这样走啊！既然她是你们的外聘职员，那么把她的酬劳预支给我当——

As they hurry off, a gust of wind suddenly slams the door shut.
随着他们迅速的动身，门被卷起的阴风，毫不留情地一把关上了。

Landlady: About that rent ...
包租婆：当租金……

Landlady: Hey! Hey, wait up! I'm not done yet! And this door's still messed up!
包租婆：喂……喂！别走啦，我还未讲完！还有，这扇门坏了啊！

She bangs on the metal door like a deranged housecat.
她敲打着铁门，焦急得仿若胡乱抓门的家猫。

Landlady: Hey, come back here! I'm locked in! Four-eyes! Come back, you ungrateful jerks!
包租婆：喂，快回来啊！我被锁住了啊！四眼仔，你们一群白眼狼啊！

But their footsteps continue to grow more distant.
门外的脚步声慢下来，旋即远远传来了应答。

Foundation Staff Member II: Sorry, ma'am! Things aren't looking so good right now. We don't have time to break you out!
圣洛夫基金会职员 II：抱歉，女士！现在局势非常不妙，暂时没有时间帮助您脱身！

Horropedia: We'll be back before you can say, "Get me out of here!"
恐怖通：我们解决完事情，马上就回来！

The landlady clenches her two great fists.
包租婆握紧双拳，拧成了沙包一样大。

Landlady: Get me out of here!! Agh, bunch of good-for-nothings! Next time I see you, I'm reporting you to your boss—no, scratch that—I'm gonna sue you for ten times the rent in emotional damages!
包租婆：死差佬……下次见面一定向你们上司投诉，不……不只投诉，我还要你们赔十倍精神损失费啊！

As her eyes adjust to the darkness, she finally notices the stark piece of white paper on the ground.
等眼睛习惯了黑暗，她终于也看到了地面上的格外反光的白纸。

She picks it up and squints as she reads each word in a slow and measured tone.
她拾起来，眯着眼睛，一字一顿的读了出来。

Landlady: "Lighthouse, midnight, get there before two heads roll."
包租婆：“西区灯塔，三更，两颗人头落地前见我。”?

...
……

Her head throbs. It feels as though it could split open at any moment as her surroundings twist and blur.
头痛欲裂，眼前的一切都在摇晃。

A stream of blood runs down her forehead and splatters onto the floor.
血从前额淌下，滴落在地。

???: We meet again, kiddo.
???: 又见面了，豆丁……

An-an Lee: Uh ...
泥鳐的士：呃……

Lighthouse
西区灯塔

An-an Lee: Who ...
泥鳐的士：哪位……

She lifts her chin, finding a stubbled face and a pair of weary, sunken eyes before her.
仰起头，那是一张胡子拉碴的面孔，以及疲惫气虚的眼睛。

The man's collar is stained yellow with neck grease. As he crouches, his grimy underwear peeks out from his slouchy pants.
衣领已经被脖颈的油脂沾得发黄，蹲下来的身子露出脏兮兮的裤衩。

One hand scratches an ankle to a foot jammed in a loose and tattered flip-flop.
被踩蹿得松松垮垮的人字拖上，一只手在挠着脚踝。

An-an Lee: Sifu?!
泥鳐的士：——师父?!

人小鬼大
The Young Exorcist GM-02

The Young Exorcist
人小鬼大

Walled City
旧城寨

In this dilapidated Walled City, newspapers once laid on the ground by the homeless now flutter and drift through the air.
脏旧的城寨中，被流浪汉用来铺就地面的报纸纷飞。

Wisps of incense smoke spiral upward, shrouding the darkness in a haze of gray.
香烛燃起的烟雾袅袅，连漆黑也蒙上了一层灰。

A forgotten corner of the city—a sunken area referred to by the elders as a forbidden zone. To enter it is to invite every vice in the world into your heart and condemn yourself to a wretched purgatory of your own creation.
一个被城市遗忘的角落，低洼之地，大人们口中的禁地。沾上它意味着会把世界上所有的恶习都带进兜里，最后过上惨不忍睹的监狱生活——

At least that's what the elders and the TV say.
至少大人，还有电视机都是那样说的。

Kong: Alright, get her bag first, and let's see what's inside. Take the cash and her pens and books and stuff.
阿猴：诺，先把她的书包扯下来，翻翻这个丫头包里都有些什么东西，把钱和文具都拿走——

An-an Lee: ...
李安安：……

Kong: Let go, you little punk!
阿猴：小八婆，你给我放手——

The boy kicks her hard, sending her crashing to the floor.
男孩伸出脚，狠狠地踹在她裙子上，让她踉跄在了地上。

Her backpack is ripped from her grasp and thrown to the ground.
书包被粗暴地拉扯到了地面上。

Kong: Yo, Chunk, hold her by the shoulders, real tight like. This city girl's guarding her bag like it's made of gold or something.
阿猴：喂，大只佬，好好按住她的肩膀——这个城区来的大小姐这么护着这个书包，里面一定有不少好东西。

Chunk: If there's food in there, I got dibs on half of it.
大只佬：如果有吃的，记得分一半给我啊。

Chunk leans forward and clamps her wrists.
大只佬探身上前，钳住她的手腕。

Kong picks up the backpack and tips out its contents onto the ground.
另一个男孩捡起书包，就像倒垃圾般，将里面的物件倾吐而出。

He flings the empty backpack into the bushes.
旋即，空肚子的书包被丢到了草丛里。

Kong: Heh, what do we have here? Cling film, cleaning stuff, some talisman paper, a wooden sword, and a lousy book.
阿猴：哼哼，让我看看都有些什么好东西——保鲜膜、清洁剂、符纸、木头剑，一本破书……

Kong: Tch, what a load of worthless crap.
阿猴：呸，都是一些没有用的垃圾啊。

He gives her possessions a few uninterested glances before finally dropping them to the ground.
他看了几眼，索然无味地丢回了地上。

Kong: Gah, not even a single penny.
阿猴：啧，她书包里一毛钱都没有啊。

Chunk: Tch, I thought she'd have something, easy. Guess she's just playing dress-up, huh?
大只佬：切……还以为是只肥羊，原来是扮阔佬的穷鬼。

The grip on An-an's wrists loosens.
女孩被钳制的手臂松开了。

She holds her head high, unfazed by the threat looming over her.
她仰起头，对自己被威胁的处境不以为意。

An-an Lee: Hey, big guy. This ghost you said you'd take me to see, it's somewhere around here, right?
李安安：喂……大只佬，你说带我去看的鬼影，就是在这附近，没错吧?

Kong: Huh? The hell she talking about?! Her brain's gotta be fried.
阿猴：啊？她的脑袋是不是坏掉了，她现在还对那个信以为真噢。

Chunk: ...
大只佬：……

He neither denies nor confirms it.
既没有否认，也没有肯定。

An-an Lee drops to the ground, narrowing her eyes as she scans the dilapidated buildings around her.
女孩立即趴倒在地，眯着眼，观察着附近破旧的楼宇。

Kong: Hey, what's up with you? You tripping or something?
阿猴：喂，你在发什么神经啊?

She turns her attention from the door of the building to the narrow space between the two adjacent skyscrapers.
她的视线从楼宇的门口，转移向隔壁的两栋大厦的夹缝。

She takes a step back, then another, until she can see the whole scene clearly.
接着后退，后退——终于望清楚了全貌。

An-an Lee: This is ...!
李安安：这是……!

She drops to her knees, the dirt pressing into her skin, and frantically opens the book lying on the ground.
她跪坐下来，膝盖抵在泥壤上，焦急地打开落在地上的书。

She turns page after page.
翻页、翻页——

An-an Lee: "Tian Zhan Sha"?
李安安：“天斩煞”?

An-an Lee: No worries, still got time. Let me check.
李安安：不要紧，还有时间……看看现在时辰——

The sky darkens as a mass of black clouds rushes in, choking the moonlight.
乌泱泱的黑云沉沉袭来，将月光尽数遮盖。

The lights hanging in the hallway begin to flicker.
楼道悬挂的灯盏，开始忽明忽暗。

The eerie contraption flashes with a vivid red warning.
死气沉沉的古怪机器，正闪烁着亮红的警示。

An-an Lee: Hmm, that's not right. The book didn't say it would happen this fast.
李安安：唔，不对路，跟书上写的不同，不应该那么快的喔……

An-an Lee: Hey! Dumbasses! Get over to the light, quick! "They" are coming for us!
李安安：喂——你两个傻仔，快跑去光亮的地方！“它们”要来了！

Chunk: What are you talking ab—
大只佬：你在说什——

A hand drops onto his shoulder.
一只手，已经幽幽搭在了他的肩膀之上。

???: Wooooo ...
???: 吱-吱-吱——

???: I will &*$# ... all of you.
???: 我也想 &*……溺们。

An-an Lee: Run!
李安安: 走啊！

She levies a swift and brutal kick to his back.
朝着他的后背，她野马般地狠狠蹬上了一脚。

Kong & Chunk: Ahhhhhhhh!
阿猴&大只佬: 啊啊啊啊啊啊啊！

The youngsters scramble into a corner, desperate for somewhere to hide.
几个小孩纷纷连滚带爬躲到了角落里。

The young, self-taught exorcist crouches down, clutching her peach-wood sword.
无师自通的儿童除灵师俯低身子，手执起了短短的桃木剑。

An-an Lee: *panting*
李安安: 呼……

???: Haha. Hmm? Been out of the game too long, huh? This little one's got some moves. I didn't know Kowloon had such talent.
???: 哈、哈哈……嗯？竟然迟了一步返工？哩个豆丁，把式还算有模有样……九龙有这么一号人吗？

He runs a hand through his messy hair and pulls at the yellow collar of his grubby shirt. He oozes the foul scent of booze from the previous night.
手抓着乱糟糟的头发，脏兮兮的发黄衣领，浑身散发着隔夜的酒酸臭。

???: This is ...
???: 这是……

His toes, which are hanging past the edge of his flip-flops, brush against the book lying on the floor.
露出脚趾的拖鞋，刚好踩到了那本地上凌乱翻卷的书。

Strange Man: Tsk, that baldy really just went ahead and sold this thing at some street stall.
陌生男人: 唉，那个光头，真就把这本书摆地摊卖了……

Strange Man: The nerve of that guy. Totally shameless. One day he's gonna find himself in more trouble than he can handle, and there'll be no way out of it.
陌生男人: 毫无公德心，小心生崽没屁股啊。

He brushes the dirt off the book and stuffs it into his pocket.
拍了拍土，塞进了兜里。

An-an Lee: Hey, old man! What's the big idea, huh? That 13 Holy Exorcism Techniques is mine, you hear me!
李安安: 喂，大叔，你在做什么……那本《除灵十三法》是我的。

Strange Man: ...
陌生男人: ……

He pulls the book from his ragged coat and dangles it by two fingers like bait.
他从破旧的外套里掏出那本书，用两手指夹着，鱼饵般高高吊起。

An-an Lee: Hey. Hey! Gimme that back ah!
李安安：喂……喂！给回我啊！

She leaps up, her hands outstretched, yet the book remains just beyond her grasp.
女孩蹦跳起来的手，距离书本始终遥不可及。

Strange Man: Your little ghost-hunting game's over, girlie.
陌生男人：除灵过家家结束了，靓妹。

rrrrip
“嘶——”

He tears the book in two and then into four. White scraps of paper spiral down into the darkness of the lower levels beneath them.
书被撕成两半，四半，雪白的碎屑飘落向黑压压的层楼底下。

An-an Lee: N-No!
李安安：不、不要——！

She charges forward without a second thought, only to be firmly restrained.
她不顾安危地冲过去，却被那只手紧紧牵制住了。

An-an Lee: What's your deal, huh? Let me go! That book's mine!
李安安：……放开我啊，那本书是我的！

Strange Man: What's my deal? That book's filled with a bunch of made-up crap. You'll get yourself into some real trouble if you believe even a word of it! I should know. I'm the one who wrote the damn thing! Almost lost my mind doing it!
陌生男人：吃错药啊你？里面都是胡编乱造，你会惹祸上身的！因为这书是我编的，我发神经写的！

An-an Lee: Huh?
李安安：哈？

Strange Man: *"... In the end, ghosts are just the product of collective imagination and mass hysteria."*
陌生男人：“……鬼从本质上来讲，只是一种集体想象和癔症。”

Strange Man: *"They're nothing but a form of energy, shaped by what you imagine them to be, like wind, radiation, or even bad gas, just a kind of energy you can't see."*
陌生男人：“它只是一种能量，承载了你对它的想象——就同风啊，辐射啊，臭屁啊一样，只是——你看不见的能量。”

Strange Man: *"That's why ghosts in different parts of the world are so distinct."*
陌生男人：“所以全世界，鬼在不同的地方，会有不同的衰样。”

Strange Man: Got it?
陌生男人：明白了吗？

His words match those in the book exactly.
一字一句都与书中的内容没有偏差。

An-an Lee: What?! No way! You're Demi-Divine Chen, the guy who could see spirits at five and started exorcizing evil at eight?! Didn't all those arcanists say you were pushing up daisies already?
李安安：你真是五岁打通天眼、八岁除遍全港恶灵的……陈半仙?！但那些神秘学家说，你早就归西了……

An-an Lee: Hey, your eyes work just fine, don't they?
李安安：而且你的眼没有盲啊？

An-an Lee: Hey, hey, Sifu! Where you running off to?!
李安安：喂、喂，师父你走这么快做咩！

Chen quickens his pace, trying to escape before he draws any more attention.
眼前的男人试图以一种不被察觉的疾走拉远距离。

An-an Lee: Hey, Sifu, how about it? You gonna take me on as your apprentice or not?! I've been dreaming of learning from you for ages! I got cash saved up! I can pay tuition!!
李安安：你收不收徒啊？师父，给个机会啦！我好敬仰好崇拜你噶！收学费都行啊，我存了好多的钱噶！

As she tugs on his clothing, the man stops.
被拽着衣服的男人停下了。

Strange Man: It's the middle of the night, kiddo. Keep it down. Look, I don't do apprentices, so you should just head home.
陌生男人：半夜三更，别吵到街坊啦……豆丁，返家吧，我不收徒噶。

Strange Man: Exorcism ain't child's play. You're just a kid. You looking to shorten your lifespan? Ever seen a dead body before? You think it's all just fun and games?
陌生男人：除灵不是儿戏，年纪轻轻，你就想折寿？见过死人未？你以为玩啊？

Strange Man: This racket'll kill ya!
陌生男人：会死人噶！

The girl cocks her head.
女孩歪起了头。

An-an Lee: Eh? Of course, I know all that. I'm not scared! Not one bit! That's exactly why I should be doing this stuff!
李安安：嗯？我当然知道啊……我才不怕嘞！而且正因如此，才能说明这是只有我能做到的事情！

A brief flash of surprise flickers in his eyes, but only for a moment.
诧异从他的眼神中流露，但只有一瞬。

He wrenches himself free from the small hand clinging to his clothes and slips into a narrow alley.
他甩开猫爪子般紧紧勾住衣服的小手，往密布的楼群巷道之间窜去。

Strange Man: Go get your head checked at the department of neurology!
陌生男人：……去挂神经科啦！

An-an Lee: Wait!
李安安：等等，大叔……！

“入井须知”
"Safety Briefings" GM-03

"Safety Briefings"
“入井须知”

Abandoned Cabin
废旧木屋

The floor is strewn with yellowed newspapers. Moths flutter around the lampshade in endless circles.
泛黄的报纸铺满了地面，飞蛾萦绕着灯罩，一圈又一圈。

The nearby wooden ladder creaks, and the doors and windows shudder with the wind.
木梯吱吱作响，门窗摇晃不停。

Despite the fragility of the house, a single door is all it takes to keep her at bay.
即便屋子如此弱不禁风，一扇门还是足以将她隔绝在外。

She has long since lost count of how long she's been coming here.
这已经是她不知第几日来到这里。

An-an Lee: Sifu, I-I'm serious! I want to be your student!
李安安：我、我真的想同你拜师啊！师父！

An-an Lee: Ever since I picked up your book at that street market, I've been reading it nonstop!
李安安：自从在那个地摊上买到你的书，我日日都在看啊！

An old, wonky iron pot filled with leftover vegetables thrown out by stall vendors and unprocessed frozen meat from the butcher's shop is boiling nearby.
凹凸不平的铁锅，正炖煮着摊贩丢弃的剩菜叶，还有肉贩未处理的冰鲜肉。

The man is sprawled across a pile of papers. He tears a few small strips, crumples them into a ball, and jams them into his ears.
躺卧在纸堆上的男人，撕下几页报纸拧成一团塞进了耳朵。

An-an Lee: I'll come tomorrow, and the day after, and the day after that! I'll come find you, no matter when, no matter what!
李安安：我明天会来，后天也会来，大后天……不管哪天！我都会来找你！

An-an Lee: I'll become the most badass Tianshi in Kowloon, I swear it!
李安安：我一定要做九龙最犀利的天师，我发过誓噶!

As the rain falls even harder outside, her voice grows increasingly faint.
外面已经下起了倾盆大雨，她的声音在门外愈发稀薄——

He gets up and starts walking.
他还是动起了脚步——

An-an Lee: Sifu!
李安安：……！师父！

Demi-Divine Chen: Rain's too hard out there. Just come in, alright? Can't have you dying on my doorstep, or you'll get me in trouble with the cops.
陈半仙：……雨太大啦，进来吧。别死在我门口，到时候差佬又找我麻烦……

An-an Lee: Ah ... Ah-choo!
李安安：啊……啊嚏！

Rolls of toilet paper lay piled on the floor like bandages torn from a mummy.
卷纸一圈圈堆叠在地上，就像刚从木乃伊身上扯下来的裹布。

Demi-Divine Chen: Now listen, I can't take you on as a student, alright? You don't respect fear. You're like a baby—ain't got a clue what a cliff is, so you're happy to walk right up to the edge of it. I ain't gonna be stuck cleaning up the mess when some clueless kid ends up going splat.
陈半仙：听着，我不能收你为徒，你对恐惧还没有敬畏之心……婴儿对悬崖没有认知，所以才能够在边上走。我不想替一个无知的豆丁收尸。

Demi-Divine Chen: You need to learn what fear is first. No one can teach you that, especially not me.
陈半仙：你首先需要学会的是恐惧，哩个没有任何人能够教你，我也无能为力。

An-an Lee: Huh? But Sifu, that's the whole reason why I wanna be your apprentice. I wanna find something that can actually make me feel scared.
李安安：嗯？但是师父，我想同你拜师除灵，就是因为我想找到一个够晒恐怖，能够吓倒我的东西……

An-an Lee: I ... I just wanna know what fear feels like! That's why I'm so into exorcizing.
李安安：我……想知道恐惧是咩感觉！这就是我要除灵的原因。

Her words hang cold in the air.
他的话放冷了。

Demi-Divine Chen: Kiddo, quit trying to make it sound so innocent when you're really just here for kicks.
陈半仙：……豆丁，少把找乐子讲得那么光明正大。

Demi-Divine Chen: Admit it, you're just another one of those little rich girls sneaking out of your fancy apartment to get a kick out of this place, ain't ya?
陈半仙：你肯定是从不知道哪栋公寓偷偷溜走，来城寨找刺激的小千金。

Demi-Divine Chen: You wanna "know what fear feels like"? Listen to yourself. What a joke!
陈半仙：“想知道恐惧是咩感觉”？你自己听下有多搞笑。

An-an Lee: Tch, fine. If you don't wanna teach me, then don't. But don't start acting like those lame teachers who lecture me all the time.
李安安：切……不想教就不教嘛，又跟那些无聊的老师一样说教……

She drops her head as she continues to mutter to herself.
女孩埋下头，那是几不可闻的嘟嘟囔囔。

Chen doesn't utter a word. Instead, he just keeps stirring the bubbling food in the pot.
男人搅拌着铁锅里的食物，不再言语。

The rain patters outside while the fire hisses and crackles.
窗外淅淅沥沥，火噼啪作响。

An-an Lee, curled up in a corner wrapped in old clothes, drifts into sleep. Before long, her rhythmic snoring fills the room.
披着旧衣服的女孩打着瞌睡，响起了均匀的呼噜声。

Demi-Divine Chen: Yo, kiddo, this ain't some daycare, you know.
陈半仙：喂，豆丁，这里不是托儿所啊……

He shakes her arm in an attempt to wake her.
他伸出手抓住她的臂膀，试图摇醒她。

Then, he notices a birthmark on it—or, no, a burn.
他的余光瞥到了手臂外侧，那是一个仿若被灼烧过的胎记。

Demi-Divine Chen: ...!
陈半仙：……！

Demi-Divine Chen: Ain't no way this is just a coincidence. Damn it.
陈半仙：不会这么巧吧……老天，唉……

...
……

...
……

Police Office
警局

Radio: "... Sources report that the fire on Xing Street has left four dead and three critically injured. Authorities have apprehended the suspects, and the survivors are currently under police protection."
收音机：“……据悉，兴街的火灾已致四人死亡，三人重伤。警方已带走相关嫌疑人，为保障证人安全，目击幸存者已被警方收容保护。”

Division of Arcane Affairs Officer I: Turn that off. Don't wake the girl.
神秘学犯罪科警员 I：关掉啦……别吵醒这个女孩。

Division of Arcane Affairs Officer I: If it weren't for her special eyes, this arcane case would've been dead in the water, and we'd be back on patrol duty.
神秘学犯罪科警员 I： 这次神秘学犯罪，要不是她的阴阳眼，破案率都要跌到让你和我滚去当巡逻警啦。

Division of Arcane Affairs Officer II: But we can't just keep the kid here like this. Doesn't she have any other family besides her parents? Are we gonna have to send her into foster care?
神秘学犯罪科警员 II： 不过，让她这样小的证人继续在局里呆下去也不是办法……除了父母以外，她还有其他亲戚吗？要送她去儿童福利院吗？

He glances at the girl on the couch. She's lying still with her back to them.
他瞥了一眼躺卧在沙发上的女孩，她仍背对着他们，一动不动。

Division of Arcane Affairs Officer I: She has a distant aunt. Says she's on her way.
神秘学犯罪科警员 I： 她还有个远房小姑，待会儿过来……

Unseen by the officers, her eyes remain open, blank, and glued to the wall.
无人察觉，她木然的双眼，仍旧瞪着那发白的墙壁。

Division of Arcane Affairs Officer I: This kid's something else. Stared right at her parents' burned corpses and didn't even flinch—not even a tear.
神秘学犯罪科警员 I： 这个女孩也够有胆……看着父母烧焦的尸体，竟然一点都不会怕，甚至连泪也不流一滴。

Division of Arcane Affairs Officer I: Word is, when the officer showed up, there were dozens of ghosts closing in on her. But she was just huddled completely still with those burns on her hands. Wasn't trying to get away or anything.
神秘学犯罪科警员 I： ……听说探员到场的时候，有几十只怨鬼围着她，但她只是蜷缩在那里，纹丝不动，也不逃，手上还有局部的严重烧伤。

Division of Arcane Affairs Officer I: She didn't come in for a statement until we'd cleared her parents' bodies.
神秘学犯罪科警员 I： 直到父母的尸体被收走，来同我们做笔录……

Division of Arcane Affairs Officer I: The bodies were alright, but man, the way her eyes are always just ... staring like that. I dunno, it creeps me out. I swear I haven't seen her blink.
神秘学犯罪科警员 I： 比起那些尸体，她那双总是不知道在看向什么的眼睛，才让我害怕……

Division of Arcane Affairs Officer II: Yeah. Doesn't cry, doesn't laugh, just has that blank, dead expression on her face. She doesn't act like a kid at all.
神秘学犯罪科警员 II： 是啊……不会哭也不会笑，就像戴着一副死僵的面具……不像个小孩啊。

Division of Arcane Affairs Officer I: They say that only the "possessed" don't get scared like that.
神秘学犯罪科警员 I： 听说，只有被鬼上身的“鬼注人”，才不会害怕。

The officer adopts a deliberate, grim frown.
警司刻意阴沉下了脸——

Division of Arcane Affairs Officer I: Maybe this kid isn't even human anymore.
神秘学犯罪科警员 I： 或许，这个小孩可能早就不是人——

Division of Arcane Affairs Officer II: ...?!
神秘学犯罪科警员 II： ……?!

Division of Arcane Affairs Officer I: Hahaha, you should see the look on your face! Relax. I'm just messing with you.
神秘学犯罪科警员 I： 哈哈哈哈哈，瞧瞧你的样子，别紧张，只是玩笑而已……

Sunlight creeps in through a crack in the door.
阳光已经从门缝里悄然照进。

Chen holds her arm, inspecting it from all sides, as though it's some sort of specimen.
他捉起她的手臂，左右端详，仿若在观察着一块标本。

An-an Lee: You done yet, Sifu? My arm's getting stiff.
李安安：师父，好了没啊……抬手好酸噶。

Demi-Divine Chen: You said this scar was from the big fire on Xing Street a year ago, right?
陈半仙：你说这个伤痕就是一年前兴街的那场大火造成的?

He lowers her arm, but his eyes repeatedly flick back to it, as if needing further confirmation.
他放下了她的手臂，迟疑的眼光仍在反复确定。

Demi-Divine Chen: Does that mean you're the girl who was on the news? Your parents ...
陈半仙：也就是说……你就是那场新闻报道里提到的女孩，你的父母——

An-an Lee: Oh, so you know about all that, Sifu? Guess I'm pretty famous, huh? Hah hah.
李安安：啊……原来师父你也知道那件事啊，看来我还挺有名的喔，嘿嘿。

An-an rubs her arm, her demeanor unexpectedly composed for someone so young.
少女揉着发酸的臂膀，显露出不似孩童的冷静。

She makes it seem as though the tragedy was just another everyday occurrence.
似乎那不过是一个稀松平常的事件。

Demi-Divine Chen: I never thought Lady Luck would find me this fast.
陈半仙：我真是想不到我的劫这么早就找上门了……

Demi-Divine Chen: The heavens have smiled upon me! Haha! You don't know how wrong you were, you blind old fool!
陈半仙：天助我，天也助我啊！死盲佬，你讲错啦……

An-an Lee: Huh? What are you talking about, Sifu?
李安安：你在讲咩啊，师父，我怎么听不明白……

He stamps out the fire, a cryptic grin curling at the corners of his mouth.
他踩灭柴火，嘴角绽开了莫名的笑容。

A mix of relief and intense satisfaction washes over him, like when you tear open a scab to savor the pain.
夹杂着释怀与痛快的，就像撕开了结痂的伤口一般的快意。

Demi-Divine Chen: Hahahahaha!
陈半仙：哈哈哈哈哈……

Demi-Divine Chen: You're really dying to be my student, huh? Then, alright, kiddo, let's do this!
陈半仙：你不是想拜我为师咩？豆丁，我同意了，我同意啦！

He flings the door open in an almost mad frenzy, grabbing the girl's hand as he charges out.
男人疯疯癫癫地打开门，拉着少女的手往外闯去。

An-an Lee: Whoa, Sifu! Where are we going now?
李安安：哇，现在我们去哪儿啊，师父?

Demi-Divine Chen: Under the Bridge.
陈半仙：……“天通洞”。

Under the Bridge
天通洞

Cars rush over the bridge above, their thunderous roars reverberating through the arches and rumbling beneath their feet.
一辆辆车从头顶行驶而过，桥洞之中回荡着滚滚轰隆声。

Beneath, a crowd of customers bustles, each of them seeking to know their fortune. One merchant, who was previously on the verge of tears, beams with joy as his fortune is told. Meanwhile, a group of foreign tourists' smiles fade as a palm reader issues them a solemn warning.
求知吉凶祸福的客人来往不绝，哭丧着脸的商人见到卦象后欣喜若狂，前来满足好奇心的外国游客，在手相师谆谆劝说下，喜颜骤失。

Each customer dreams of seeing what lies beyond destiny's veil. Though some spend their last coin here, others strike it rich with destiny's ultimate jackpot.
所有客人都想窥探命运幕布后的景象，但总有人散尽钱财，总有人刮出命运的头彩——

And that is how this location, known only as "Under the Bridge," has earned its infamous reputation.
“天通洞”由此臭名昭著。

Blind Fortune Teller: Here. Crush this talisman into pieces and eat a little three times a day after meals for three days, and all will be well.
盲眼算命师：呐……将你符纸捏碎成屑，一日三次，饭后服下，三个疗程便可——

Tourist: Thank you, master! You're a lifesaver!
游客：多谢，多谢师父搭救！

Blind Fortune Teller: Wait!
盲眼算命师：等等……

The blind fortune teller sniffs the air, detecting a familiar odor.
盘腿而坐的盲眼算命师嗅到了熟悉的味道。

An-an Lee: Whoa, Sifu, I didn't know there was such a big place down here! Could open a new office down here! You don't wanna live here?
李安安：哇，师父，我都不知原来这下边别有洞天！都可以开个新事务所嘞……你在这里住不好吗？

Demi-Divine Chen: Hurry it up, kid. Ain't nothing worth seeing here.
陈半仙：走……快走啦，没什么好看的。

He pulls An-an as she tries to take in her surroundings, her head swiveling as she tries to see it from every angle.
他迫不及待逃离，拉着左顾右盼的女孩往更深的地方走去——

A hand grabs his collar.
一只手拽住了他的衣领。

Blind Fortune Teller: Well, well, heh-heh. If it isn't Demi-Divine Chen! I thought you'd already made it big. What are you still doing walking around Under the Bridge, eh?
盲眼算命师：喔……陈半仙先生，我还以为你早发达啦，怎么还得空大驾光临我们“天通洞”嘞？

An-an Lee: Huh? Aren't you supposed to be blind, mister?
李安安：咦……？你不是盲佬吗，大叔。

She waves her hand in front of the fortune teller's sunglasses.
她在算命师的墨镜前挥了挥手。

Blind Fortune Teller: Even a blind man can light a lamp. Blind eyes don't make for a blind heart, missy. I had already foreseen his return.
盲眼算命师：盲佬也会点灯啊。眼盲不代表心盲，后生女……我早算到他会返来啦。

Blind Fortune Teller: As for you, little lady.
盲眼算命师：至于你……妹妹仔。

He snatches An-an's waving hand and grips it tight.
他猛地伸手，抓住了眼前挥动的手腕。

Blind Fortune Teller: Remarkable bones. Heh-heh. What a fine specimen you are. Your destiny is in perfect balance after surviving such a calamity. Certainly not one to be confined by anything.
盲眼算命师：骨骼精奇，好坯子啊……刚渡大劫，命数归一，不是囚困樊笼之人。

Blind Fortune Teller: But ... your parents ...
盲眼算命师：不过，你……父母，唉。

Blind Fortune Teller: *sigh* It's too soon. Far too soon. You shouldn't have brought her here.
盲眼算命师：唉……但还是太早了，还是太早了，你不该带她来。

Demi-Divine Chen: Hey! Let go, you blind old fool.
陈半仙：喂……放手啦，死盲佬。

Chen's expression turns dark as he drags An-an off.
他的脸部骤然变色，拉走了她。

An-an Lee: Sifu?
李安安：师父?

He continues to pull her without a word, barging through the crowd.
他二话不说，拉着女孩穿过熙攘人群，往更深的尽头走去——

As they go, An-an's eyes remain fixed on the blind fortune teller under the bridge, as if holding a non-existent gaze.
而女孩始终回望桥洞底下的盲眼算命师，仿佛在进行着不存在的对视。

Blind Fortune Teller: There's no escaping it! Accept your destiny!
盲眼算命师：你逃不过，安守天命啦！

A bottomless well yawns before them. Chen stands at the edge and takes a deep breath.
那是一口望不到底部的深井，他站在井口前，深呼了一口气。

Demi-Divine Chen: Listen up, kiddo. This well, they call it Destiny. It's been here since long before this bridge even existed.
陈半仙：听着，丫头。这口井，叫作“天命”——早在这座桥立起以前，就一直在这里。

Demi-Divine Chen: If you wanna be an exorcist and study under me, you're gonna have to dive into this well and pull your own calamity hexagram out of the muck at the bottom of it.
陈半仙：想吃除灵这碗饭的，拜师登堂——就要先下这口井，从底下的泥壤里掏出属于你的劫卦。

Demi-Divine Chen: This is the first karmic trial for any exorcist. Once you pass this test, you'll be worthy of calling yourself an exorcist.
陈半仙：这个，叫除灵师的第一劫。开了这个劫，你才有资格吃这碗饭。

He loosens the dirt around the well's edge and pulls out a rusty copper chain.
他刨开井口前的一片土，一条盘起来的锈铜锁链被他拽出。

Demi-Divine Chen: Otherwise, it ends here. You go your way, I go mine, and you don't come bothering me anymore, you hear?
陈半仙：否则——我们的缘分就到这里，今后各走各路，你也不要再缠着我。

An-an Lee: For real? Too easy! Let me take a look.
李安安：真噶？Easy 啦～等我看下先！

She clutches the rim of the well as she leans over to stare into the abyss below.
女孩抓紧井的边沿，探出身子，朝洞里望去。

The well's walls are thick with complex yellow talismans, as if they've grown from the bottom like ivy.
井壁上，错综复杂的黄色符咒，宛如沿墙而上的爬山虎密布。

The deeper it goes, the more tightly packed the talismans become, until not a single ray of light can be seen.
越往深处，符咒交叠的程度便越密……融不进一丝光亮。

An-an Lee: Tch ...
李安安：嘶……

A cold wind rushes from the bottom of the well, sending a shiver down her spine.
一股阴风从井底冲上，刮得她寒毛耸立。

Demi-Divine Chen: Alright, listen up. I'm gonna wrap this chain around you. Then, you get in the bucket, and I'll lower you down to the bottom, nice and slow. Now—
陈半仙：呐……我接下来会把这条锁链捆在你身上，你要爬进铁桶，我会慢慢把你下放到井底。以及——

He unfastens the Three-Clarities Bell from his belt and secures it around the girl's waist.
他将裤腰上的三清铃松开，系在了女孩的腰上。

Demi-Divine Chen: Keep this bell on. If you run into any trouble, ring it three times, and I'll pull you up in a flash.
陈半仙：戴好这个铃，如果有任何问题，摇铃三声——我会立即拉你上来。

Demi-Divine Chen: Got it? You want out, you ring the bell.
陈半仙：只要你想出来，就摇铃。

An-an Lee: Got it, Sifu! You know I'm a night owl. Darkness doesn't scare me. I can handle it. I'll pull that calamity hexagram right out. Just don't go back on your word, okay?
李安安：定啦，师父，湿湿碎。我天生属夜猫啊，两三下就可以把那个咩劫卦拿出来，等一下你别反悔就好啦～

She climbs into the bucket, and he slowly lowers her into the well.
她攀爬进铁桶，往井底缓缓下沉。

At first, she feels like a stone sinking into the ocean, the light still caught in her eyes, but then darkness envelops her, and she is left in complete darkness.
一开始似是一颗落海的石子，她的眼睛仍闪着光亮，紧接着，黑暗闭幕般遮盖了所有的光源。

In the blink of an eye ...
几乎是瞬间的功夫。

The stone hits the bottom.
石子沉底了。

...
……

Blind Fortune Teller: She doesn't know, does she? That you've never been to the bottom of that well—never faced your own trial.
盲眼算命师：她知道你从没有下过井底，从来没有开过自己的劫吗?

Blind Fortune Teller: She doesn't know that you were the one who performed an unlicensed exorcism and burned down those buildings a year ago. Oh yes, heh-heh, I know she's the orphan who made the headlines!
盲眼算命师：一年前，就是因为你无证除灵，足足烧了好几栋楼……她就是新闻里报道的那个孤儿啊！

Blind Fortune Teller: The cops might not have pinned it on you, but the karma you've sown ... Hah! You'll reap it in time!
盲眼算命师：差佬不定你的罪，但你自己种下的因……迟早要还噶！

Blind Fortune Teller: And no Tianshi has ever let anyone so young go down the well! Even if she does come back, she'll be in a trance for days. Some of her three souls and seven spirits are bound to be lost forever.
盲眼算命师：而且之前几代的天师，从来没有那么小就许可下井的！就算出得来，也免不了几天几夜的神情恍惚，三魂七魄都会走几个。

Blind Fortune Teller: You're totally unfit to be an exorcist. You realize that, don't you? You've already hurt so many people, and now you're going to hurt her too?
盲眼算命师：你根本无资格当除灵师，你明不明白？你已经害了够多人了，还要害她？

Demi-Divine Chen: You blind fool, just wait and see.
陈半仙：……盲佬，等着吧。

Demi-Divine Chen: One calamity cancels out another. I brought her here. If she doesn't survive, her calamity will bury mine, and I'll finally have peace.
陈半仙：劫数相盖，一劫替一劫。我带她过来，只要她没顶住这个劫，她所遭的劫会掩埋掉我的劫……我就可以保住安稳。

Demi-Divine Chen: Once she rings the bell, our karmic connection will end, and we'll both be safe. We'll part ways, at peace, and there'll be nothing owed between us.
陈半仙：只要她摇铃，到时候，我和她的因果会断，我们相安无事，互不相欠。

Blind Fortune Teller: My Sifu up in the heavens, I shouldn't have given you my eyes! It's not too late. There's still time to make this right!
盲眼算命师：师父在天之灵，我就不该把我的眼睛给你！现在为时不晚！

The blind man lunges forward and tries to lift the chain with his bare hands. The tremendous force carving bloody gashes into his palms.
盲佬赶忙走过去，试图徒手拉起锁链，巨大的拉力在他的手上勒出一道血痕。

But the chain remains unmoved.
锁链纹丝不动。

Demi-Divine Chen: It's pointless. This is her trial to bear. No one intervenes unless that bell rings.
陈半仙：无用噶，这是她开的劫。除非听到摇铃，否则我们谁都没得插手。

Blind Fortune Teller: Heavens, this is terrible! If her trial leads to her end down there, you won't get away with it!
盲眼算命师：唉，作孽……如果她因为自己的劫，死在井底，你也跑不掉！

Demi-Divine Chen: It's worth the risk. Who knows? Even a bicycle could turn into a motorcycle.
陈半仙：搏一搏，单车变摩托啊，死盲佬。

...
……

红丝线
Red Binding Thread GM-04

Red Binding Thread
红丝线

You can hear them, can't you?
你能听到他们的话，不是吗？

You're just like me—another poor thing they've cast aside.
你跟我一样，也是被他们抛弃的可怜东西。

Another child left behind and forgotten.
也是被遗忘掉的孩子。

An-an Lee: Huh? Where's that voice coming from? A cop's walkie-talkie, or is it some kind of off-screen narration thing?
李安安：……奇了，D 声音哪里传出来噶？同那些差人噶 call 机一样，咩旁白画外音啊。

Her hand brushes against the well's wall. She feels the damp moss clinging to it.
目不可见，她用手抚摸井壁，有着苔藓湿漉漉的质感。

The well's bottom is inescapable. The stones form a cramped, stifling cage.
这是一个没有出口的井底，砖石围成了逼仄、狭窄的牢圈。

An-an Lee: Hold on! The moss ... Is it moving?
李安安：等等，苔藓……这些苔藓动起来了？

As the moss creeps and crawls like a thousand centipedes, the wall fades away.
墨绿色的苔藓宛如数千只蜈蚣般蠕动，墙面消失了。

Now, I can feel you, too.
现在，我也摸到你了。

An-an Lee: ...!
李安安：……！

Little Rooney: Okay, big mouth! Think you're so special, with those yin-yang eyes you're always bragging about, huh? Then have fun sleeping in here tonight!
鲁尼小子：好啦，喇叭妹——乖乖地在里边睡啦，你不是爱出风头，还说自己是阴阳眼咩？

He pats the metal cabinet bound in chains.
他拍了拍被锁链缠起来的铁皮柜子。

Little Rooney: I hear this old classroom gets real lively around midnight. Since you were so happy to mess up our plan and get us in trouble, how about I give you the chance to see a real ghost?
鲁尼小子：听讲这个旧教室，午夜好热闹的噢……既然你好开心戳破我们的局，还搞到我们被老师骂，就给个机会你见见真鬼啦。

Little Rooney: Yo, pour some of the crow's blood on the cabinet! You're her bestie, aren't ya? Lend a hand, won't ya?
鲁尼小子：喂，将乌鸦血淋到柜子上，你不是她的好姐妹咩——帮下手啦，嗯？

He pulls at the girl's hair, pushing her roughly toward the cabinet.
他揪住另一位女生的头发，推搡着。

Zhenmei: I don't want to do this, An-an. I-I'm sorry. *sob*
阿珍妹：我也不想这样做噶，安安……对、对不住……呜呜呜……

An-an stares through the gaps in the cabinet.
被关起来的女孩从柜子缝里窥探着外面。

An-an Lee: Eh? What am I doing here?
李安安：咦，怎么是哩个地方……

An-an Lee: Wait, is this like one of those creepy movies where I have to relive all my fears and sadness, basically all the messed-up stuff that happened to me, all over again?
李安安：难道好似那些恐怖电影里面演的，我必须先重复经历一遍那些害怕啦恐怖啦，悲伤啦，总之就是怎么难受怎么走的整蛊心魔体验？

An-an Lee: Then, I must be the main character! I'm gonna level up and beat the crap out of all those creepy creepsters!
李安安：然后那些衰仔主角才会成长，打败咩古怪的敌人——哇，这么讲，我就是主角啦！

An-an Lee: But hang on. I'm not scared one bit! So, doesn't that mean I won't "level up" at all?!
李安安：但是……弊家伙，我一点也不惊喔。这样讲，我岂不是就完全“成长”不了！

An-an Lee: This is ...
李安安：这里又是……?

The Darkness Under the Bed: I've been waiting for you down here for so long. You do remember me, don't you?
床底的黑影：我在底下等你好久好久了……还记得我吗?

The Darkness Under the Bed: Those old dolls you threw down here, hee-hee-hee. Their bodies have really come in handy.
床底的黑影：被你丢弃的那些娃娃，嘻嘻嘻，他们的身体好好用。

Numerous twisted hands extend from beneath the bed, grabbing and clawing at her ankles.
床底伸出数只关节扭曲的手，犹如缠绕的荆棘般抓住了她的脚腕。

An-an Lee: ...!
李安安：……!

The arms drag her, their sharp nails scraping her legs and drawing blood.
它们拖拽，它们血淋淋的指甲在腿上刮蹭，留下一片血污。

She slips and falls.
女孩滑倒在地。

An-an Lee: Hahaha, so itchy ah! Stop tickling my feet! Hahahaha! You guys seriously need to work on your technique!
李安安：哈哈哈，好痒啊……别挠我脚心哈哈哈，你、你们的手法太外行了！

An-an Lee: Hey, you're doing it all wrong! And couldn't you clean your nails first? How's your customer supposed to feel comfortable with them all dirty like that? Let me show you how it's done!
李安安：呐，脚，不是这样按的！你们连指甲都没有剪干净，顾客怎么会舒服呢！唉，我来教你啦！

She clutches one of the bloodied hands, folds the fingers, and demonstrates by scraping the knuckles across the sole of her foot.
她抓住其中一只满是血污的手，掰弯手指头，言传身教地用指节剐蹭足底。

An-an Lee: Hey, the old massage guy downstairs from my place says ... ah, this is the Yongquan point. With all the time you spend under the bed, it's no wonder you're always getting headaches. So damp and humid down there.
李安安：呐，我楼下的推拿阿爷说……哩个叫做涌泉穴，你们常年呆在床底下，难免阴湿，容易头痛。

An-an Lee: Now, how about this one?!
李安安：而哩个呢……

Just as her massage course nears its end, a blinding white light interrupts her.
兢兢业业的教导还未结束，白光迎面打断了讲述。

Decaying corpses, their flesh half rotten, slowly crawl through the mist.
腐烂了半边身子的尸体，在迷雾中匍匐。

Their tortured cries fill the air as they drag themselves forward by their teeth and half-severed fingers.
他们哀嚎遍地，用牙齿与半截指头向前艰难地前进，仿佛坐着轮椅追赶小偷的老人。

Corpse I: Ah #@￥ ... Give me back my hand ... #% ... @
僵尸 Ⅰ：啊 #@￥……把我从坟堆里伸出去的手还给我……#%……@

Corpse II: Don't play with that! #*￥ ... That's not a marble—that's my eye!
僵尸 Ⅱ：别弹它 #*￥那不是弹珠，是我的眼珠啊！

An-an bounds from one gravestone to another like a cat, glancing down at her pursuers below.
女孩从一个墓碑跃到另一个墓碑顶部，就像一只叼走鱼干的猫儿，俯视着脚下的追兵。

An-an Lee: Aunty always says, "Turn the other cheek." Hehe! If you can catch me, I'm all yours!
李安安：我姑妈同我讲过，要“打不还手”，嘿嘿。捉到我就给你们啦！

It's so boring.
一点也不好玩

It's so boring.
一点也不好玩

As everything darkens once more, the walls draw inward, curving and forming a ring around her.
四周重新变得昏暗，墙壁收拢、弯曲，围成一圈——

In the darkness, a soft glow emerges from the soil, sparkling in scattered clusters.
昏暗中，微弱的光从土地生长而出，星星点点。

An-an Lee: Huh? Back already? I'm not done having fun yet.
李安安：嗯？这么快就返来啦？我都未玩够喔……

A boy sits in the corner, curled up like a ball.
角落里，蹲坐着一个蜷缩起来的男孩。

His thumbs are fastened together with a red rope.
两只拇指被一根红线紧紧缠住。

An-an Lee: Huh? So you're the one who's been yapping all this time?
李安安：咦，你就是一直讲话那个人啊?

It's my job to figure out the fears of those who come down the well.
寻索下井人的恐惧是我的职守

Dig up the dirt beneath you with your hands.
用手刨开你脚下的那片土

What you're looking for is right there.
你想找的东西就在那儿

An-an Lee: Wow, thanks for the help!
李安安：好耶，多谢帮衬喔！

She squats down, grinning as she digs into the soil, piling one mound of dirt after another, like a child playing on the beach.
她蹲下来，就像沙滩上的孩童一样兴奋地刨着土地，一堆、再一堆。

She finds the solid wooden hexagram jutting out from the dirt. She reaches out to grab it, only to stop midway.
坚硬的木卦如同嫩笋露出了尖儿，她伸出手试图拿起——突然停住了。

An-an Lee: Hey, hang on a minute.
李安安：不过，等等……

An-an Lee: If I take this hexagram, does that mean I won't have to worry about anything anymore? No disasters, no sickness? Like the adults said, I can "rest easy and without a care"?
李安安：喂……是不是只要我拿到了这个卦，以后就可以逃过所有麻烦啦？不论灾祸病痛。也就是那些大人所讲的“高枕无忧”?

She folds her legs and sits down.
她盘腿坐下来。

An-an Lee: If life's all smooth sailing—no twists, no turns—isn't it kinda pointless?
李安安：……如果真是风调雨顺，如意到头。那不是好无意思……

An-an Lee: I've been at this for ages, and I still haven't found anything actually mind-blowing. What's the point in becoming a Tianshi anyway?
李安安：寻寻觅觅，找了这么久，我都还没有找见一个真正令我惊的东西——就算成为了天师，又有咩用呢……

Thinking about those long, tiresome days ahead, she feels an unbearable itch somewhere inside.
一想到将来那冗长、百无聊赖的日子，她就感到心痒难搔。

An-an Lee: Oh, now I get it! Aren't you the "expert" who hunts down fear for all the up-and-coming Tianshi?
李安安：不过……是了！你不是替所有天师寻索恐惧的“专家”咩?

An-an Lee: Surely you can find something that'll really shock me, right?
李安安：你一定有办法找到令我惊的东西吧?

She rises, marching boldly toward the white light.
她站起来，大步靠近白色的光影。

An-an Lee: Ehhh, you wanna come with me and find something really scary?
李安安：要不要……跟我一起出去，找到这个世界上真正恐怖的东西嘞?

???: Really? I can leave this place?
???: 真的，可以离开这里吗?

An-an Lee: Hehe, sure you can! I never, ever make empty promises.
李安安：嘿嘿，当然，我李安安几时讲过大话。

An-an Lee: Hang on. I'll help you undo this red string here.
李安安：你等一等哈，我帮你解开这条红绳子。

She gently pulls at the red thread wrapped around his thumbs as though unraveling the layers of a cocoon.
她的手拨开勒紧拇指的红线，仿若在剪除层层茧丝。

With every coil she unravels, the fog begins to dissipate.
每解开一层，井底的雾气就散去几重。

The talisman papers tear free from the well's walls and float down from above, settling in a pile on the ground.
符纸从井壁上脱落，漫天纷飞，从头顶散落而下，堆叠在地上。

ding The red thread snaps.
“叮”——红线断开了。

An-an Lee: Hahaha! Easy-peasy!
李安安：哈哈哈，搞定!

An-an Lee: Eh, where's he gone? So weird.
李安安：人嘞？奇了……

The dried-up bottom of the well starts to grow wet.
干涸的井底变得湿润。

An-an Lee: What the heck? Why are my feet getting all sticky? This some kind of water ghost or what?
李安安：脚底下也黏糊糊的，莫名其妙……难道它是水鬼化身?

The water has already risen to her ankles.
她看见脚踝处，已经没到了一层水面。

Suddenly, a massive geyser bursts from the center of the well, spraying water everywhere.
紧接着——井底中心冒出了一个巨大的泉涌口，水源迸发而出。

An-an Lee: Wha—! What kinda ghost is this?!
李安安：哇——！这是咩鬼啊！

The fallen talisman papers swirl in the water as it reaches her waist.
水吞没到腰间，卷动着散落的符纸，宛如泄洪般灌溉充盈着这口井。

An-an Lee: *cough* H-Help! Help me, Sifu!
李安安：咳、咳咳……救、救命啊师父！

She swings the Three-Clarities Bell in vain, unable to emit any sound beneath the water.
三清铃徒劳地晃荡，在水下发不出任何声音。

The water stings her nose and chokes her throat. She coughs violently as she struggles to stay on the water's surface.
呛到了鼻子，呛到了喉咙，她剧烈地咳嗽着，挣扎着挥舞双手浮起。

As the water level continues to rise, light pours in from above her head.
而随着水位的上升，光芒也照耀到了头顶之上——

Water rushes out from the well, tossing the unconscious girl and the silent bell onto the ground.
水从井口漫溢而出，顺势将昏厥的小女孩也吐在了地上，以及那只未响起的铃铛。

Blind Fortune Teller: Wait, she's out?! This little girl, she ... she actually did it?!
盲眼算命师：喂，她难道出来了……?！哩个妹妹仔，她、她成功了?!

Demi-Divine Chen: How? How is this even possible?
陈半仙：……怎么，怎么可能……

Chen whispers under his breath, paying no attention to her.
男人喃喃低语着，完全忽视了她。

The fortune teller stumbles over to the girl and slaps her back to help her cough up the water from her throat and nose.
算命师踉跄着找到女孩，上前拍打着女孩的背部，让她把呛在喉咙和鼻孔里的水咳出。

With a final splutter of water, she takes a gasp of air.
——直至呼吸平稳。

Blind Fortune Teller: Good. Very good. But I can't quite see. What's that in her hand? A flower?
盲眼算命师：太好了。不过，我看不到……她手里拿着咩？是……花吗?

Clutched in her palm, wrapped in red binding thread, is a mysterious-looking ...
缠着红丝线，那是一只诡谲的——

Lily.
百合花。

惊情回魂夜
Outside the Darkness GM-05

Outside the Darkness
惊情回魂夜

Blind Fortune Teller: Some sixty or seventy years ago, archaeologists came across bamboo slips inscribed with talismans to drive away evil spirits hidden among the Eastern Han tombs, along with the dozens of sealed wells.
盲眼算命师：六七十年前，一群考古学家在东汉的墓葬群里，发现了驱逐恶鬼的符箓竹简，还有十几口封井的位置。

Blind Fortune Teller: The story behind the sealed wells remains a mystery. The professors studying those ancient texts refuse to speak about them.
盲眼算命师：具体为何有封井的说法，那帮解析古文字的教授守口如瓶，无人知晓。

Blind Fortune Teller: My master's master, and those before him, all said the same—this Destiny had been a dry well for centuries.
盲眼算命师：我师父的师父，再往上不知几代的师父，都只同我讲过，这“天命”几百年来始终是口枯井——

Blind Fortune Teller: Now, a spring has surged to the surface, and the well overflows. Maybe its mission has come to an end now that it has crossed paths with that girl.
盲眼算命师：而如今，泉水涌出，井口充盈——或许，真的是它使命已尽，遇到哩个女孩了。

Blind Fortune Teller: Her karmic bond with Under the Bridge has ended. No need to watch the well anymore. You can take her back now.
盲眼算命师：她同“天通洞”的因果到此为止，从此以后我们也不必再守井，你可以送她返去了……

Blind Fortune Teller: Stay away from her and stay out of trouble, and maybe you'll avoid your own calamity.
盲眼算命师：离她远点，自找安分吧，这样也能避开你的劫。

Demi-Divine Chen: I know where to draw the line.
陈半仙：……我知道分寸。

He chooses not to respond to the blind fortune teller's words.
他不打算回应盲佬的话语。

...
……

...
……

Ten days later
十日后

This is the agreed meeting spot, deserted and lifeless. When you're among the dead, there is no one who can share your secrets.
他还是约定在了这个地方，荒废、死寂——没有活人会走漏风声。

An-an sits on a rock opposite Chen, swinging her legs.
身前的女孩跨坐在石头上，晃悠悠地荡着双腿。

Demi-Divine Chen: Since you've proven yourself qualified, I'll tell you the rules passed down from our great grandmaster.
陈半仙：既然你已过关，根据祖师爷的规矩，我就同你约法三章。

Demi-Divine Chen: Sit still and listen carefully.
陈半仙：现在，你坐定。

An-an straightens up, her legs no longer swinging, and listens carefully.
她停止了晃荡的腿，竖起耳朵，认真地听着每字每句。

Demi-Divine Chen: First, never mention anything about that well to anyone.
陈半仙：第一，与“天命”那口井有关的一切事情，以后，你切不可泄露天机。

Demi-Divine Chen: Second, now that your bond is severed, you must never return to the well. Ever. Understand?
陈半仙：第二，因果已定，你也永不能再返回那口井。

Demi-Divine Chen: If you break either of these rules, I swear on our great grandmaster, you'll be struck by lightning.
陈半仙：如若失口乱言，祖师爷在上，一定五雷轰顶。

An-an Lee: So, I can't tell anyone about Lily.
李安安：这么说……今后，Lily 的事，无论如何都再不能泄露给他人半句……

She murmurs to herself before giving a firm nod.
女孩先是喃喃低语，旋即点了点头。

An-an Lee: I understand, Sifu.
李安安：……我明白了，师父。

Her tone sounds serious, as if she's grown up all of a sudden.
女孩凝重起来的脸，瞬间褪去了以往所有的童趣感。

Demi-Divine Chen: Good. Then ...
陈半仙：好……那么……

Demi-Divine Chen: Listen up, kiddo. Now that you're my apprentice, it's time to start with the first teaching—Russian Courage Training.
陈半仙：豆丁，听好了。拜师后第一门课，我先要教你“俄罗斯练胆大法”——

He guides the girl, her eyes covered by a red cloth. She extends both hands forward, groping at the air in an attempt to determine her location.
他牵着被红布蒙住眼睛的少女。她两手向前伸展着，试图摸清楚自己的位置。

An-an Lee: Whoa, Sifu, I can't see a thing! What kind of courage training is this? The ghosts are, like, totally invisible with this thing on!
李安安：哇，师傅，我咩都看不到，练咩胆啊！鬼在我面前都变空气啦！

Demi-Divine Chen: Most of these so-called ghosts are just images people conjure up, energy-taking form based on human imagination. That's why ghosts in the East and West are so different from one another, and the methods for exorcizing them are so distinct.
陈半仙：大多数所谓的鬼，都是人们自己创造出来的形象——它本质上是一种能量，根据人的想象才有模有样。所以东西方的鬼魂有所区别，除灵方式亦大相径庭。

Demi-Divine Chen: In essence, those ghost-hunting amateurs don't banish the energy itself. They only use their so-called tools to clear the imagination from their own minds.
陈半仙：本质上，那些外行的人并没有除去能量，他们只是通过所谓的工具，除去了自己脑内的想象。

Demi-Divine Chen: It's like how people turn on the light to drive away the darkness. It's a short-term fix, only capable of handling the weakest of energies.
陈半仙：就像人们开灯才不怕黑，但那只是一时的举措，只能够对付一些微弱的能量。

Demi-Divine Chen: People who believe in ghosts also play a part in creating their image, but as exorcists, we must go beyond the imagination and see the ghost's essence to get rid of it.
陈半仙：当人相信鬼的同时，便也参与了创造鬼的形象。但除灵师不一样，我们必须打破想象，我们要看到鬼的本质，才能药到病除。

Demi-Divine Chen: Exorcists are generally born with yin-yang eyes. Believe me, more than one exorcist has been known to go insane after letting their imagination run wild.
陈半仙：除灵师一般有天生的阴阳眼，所以如果乱加想象，就容易导致疯病。

An-an Lee: So, I'm not supposed to see them the way I imagine them in my head?
李安安：所以……我不能看见他们在我的想象中已有的样子?

He adjusts her blindfold, pulling it tighter.
他把李安安的蒙面布系得更紧了。

Demi-Divine Chen: That's right. Kiddo, you'll be staying here tonight. I've set up a tent and paper effigies for you. When midnight has passed, you'll start burning the spirit money on your own.
陈半仙：没错……豆丁，今晚你要自己在这里过夜，我已经为你备好了帐篷和纸人……一过三更，你自己开始烧纸。

Demi-Divine Chen: I'll come by to pick you up tomorrow morning. If you take off the blindfold halfway through, don't bother waiting for me. Just go back home.
陈半仙：明天一早，我会过来接你。如果你中途摘下蒙布，就不必与我相认，自己返家啦。

The girl hesitates as if she wants to say something but decides against it.
少女踌躇着，似乎欲言又止。

Demi-Divine Chen: It's not too late to back out now. If you've changed your mind, don't go wasting your time.
陈半仙：现在反悔都可以……就不必白费功夫啦。

An-an Lee: No, it's not that. Sifu, I've been meaning to ask, how come you're not afraid of ghosts, but you're afraid of that "calamity" of yours?
李安安：不是啊……师父，我只是一直有问题想问，为什么你连鬼都不怕，却要怕那个劫嘞?

An-an Lee: I heard you guys talking when I was at the bottom of the well. That old blind man was saying something about me being your calamity and some stuff about karma. Is that really how it works?
李安安：我在井底的时候有听到你们讲话喔……那个瞎子大叔讲咩我是你的劫，还有咩因果——真是那样吗?

Chen goes quiet. He didn't anticipate this.
男人陷入了沉默，这远在他意料之外。

Demi-Divine Chen: You heard?
陈半仙：你听到啦?

A cold laugh escapes his mouth.
他唇齿之间发出了冷笑。

A gust of wind rushes through the cemetery.
空寂的墓园中，寒风阵阵。

Demi-Divine Chen: Ain't you worried that I'll leave you here to die and no one will ever find out, kiddo?
陈半仙：那你不惊我是把你丢在这里，等你个豆丁死了都无人知吗?

The girl cracks a smile, as if she's just heard a twisted joke.
少女咧开了嘴角，仿若只是听到一个冷笑话。

An-an Lee: Hahaha! Sifu, you wouldn't do that! I know you're not cut out to be a bad guy.
李安安：哈哈哈哈……师父，你不舍得噶！我知道你才不是当反派的料。

Chen waves his hand.
男人摆了摆手。

Demi-Divine Chen: My calamity is ordained by destiny. Ain't no avoiding it. Since I haven't gone down the well, it'll come for me eventually, and you'll be the one to lead it here.
陈半仙：劫是天命，是难违的。我没有下过井，它就迟早会回来找我——而且会由你亲自带来。

Demi-Divine Chen: I'm only willing to teach you because I know you won't be able to handle it, and my calamity will be delayed and ultimately averted.
陈半仙：所以我愿意教你，是因为我信你会顶不住——只要你顶不住，我的劫就可以避，可以推迟。

Demi-Divine Chen: As for ghosts? They're no big deal to me, not a real threat at all.
陈半仙：而鬼？对我来讲，那只是一些鸡毛蒜皮的小东西。

Demi-Divine Chen: This place, though, it's haunted as heck, kiddo. Be careful, or you might end up covered in blood with your head split open.
陈半仙：你知不知道，这里好邪的，豆丁……小心血光之灾，头破血流啊！

Demi-Divine Chen: See you at sunrise, kiddo.
陈半仙：明日天一亮，我会再来接你的，豆丁。

An-an Lee: Sure, a night like this is way too fun to pass up! And with Lily here, I'm gonna be just fine!
李安安：无问题，这么刺激的夜晚太难得啦！何况我有 Lily 陪我，一定平安无恙啦！

She holds the unblossomed lily close, squatting down like a devoted believer.
她抱紧仍未盛放的百合花，蹲坐着，就像一位虔诚的教徒。

...
……

...
……

Dawn
黎明

Chen makes his way through the light morning mist, crossing the cemetery with eager anticipation in his steps.
男人满怀期待地穿过薄雾，穿过墓园——

Fading Spirit: Please, I'm begging you, take her ... just take her away, please ...
奄奄一息的鬼魂：求哈你，带她走啦@#￥#……求哈你……

The ground is littered with talisman papers. The ghost desperately claws its way back under the gravestone, but its hand happens to grab Chen's ankle in the process.
符纸满地散落，一只鬼魂正艰难地爬回墓碑底下，却碰巧抓住了他的脚踝。

Demi-Divine Chen: Ugh!
陈半仙：呃……！

Thrown off balance, he plummets to the ground, his head colliding with the gravestone on the way down.
他顿时天旋地转，在一个大大的倒栽葱后，脑袋重重磕在了墓碑上。

An-an Lee: Whoa! Sifu, is that you?
李安安：哇……师父，是你吗?

An-an finally removes the blindfold.
少女终于得以摘下蒙布。

She dashes forward, ignoring Chen and grabbing the fleeing ghost.
她奔跑过来，却顾不及男人，而是抓住了那只试图遁逃的“能量”——

An-an Lee: Hey, wait up! This brick's not even fully charged yet! Boss, I just need a bit more. Why're you taking a nap?!
李安安：喂，别走啊！这台大哥大都未充满电！大佬，顶多一阵啦，这么早睡做咩！

Demi-Divine Chen: ...
陈半仙：……

Vegetable scraps and plastic bags float in the dirty water at their feet, emitting a repulsive stench.
脚底下菜叶、塑料袋在泔水上漂浮，泛起一阵令人恶心的味道。

An-an Lee: Sifu, what kind of ghost are we hunting now? It smells so bad. I'm gonna have to scrub for three days straight to get this stink off. Urgh!
李安安：师父……我们这次除咩鬼啊，这里闻上去臭到我洗三天三夜都洗不干净啊……呃……

An-an Lee: One more thing, Sifu. Your head's really okay?
李安安：还有，师父……你的头真的没有事吧?

He waves his hand once again.
男人再次摆了摆手。

Demi-Divine Chen: *cough* It's nothing.
陈半仙：咳咳……小、小问题。

Demi-Divine Chen: This time, I'm taking away all your exorcism tools. Tonight, you're gonna have to survive in this stinky ghost hole all by yourself.
陈半仙：这次，我要收回你身上所有的除灵工具，你今晚必须在这个臭烘烘的鬼地方自力更生。

Demi-Divine Chen: If you wanna be an exorcist, you've gotta be adaptable, like those alchemists in the mountains, grabbing whatever's at hand.
陈半仙：要做除灵师就意味着拥有随机应变的能力，你要学那些在山里苟延残喘的炼丹师，随地捡拾可以用的东西。

Demi-Divine Chen: Whether it's a toilet plunger or your grandma's dentures, you've gotta use whatever works. Think outside the box. Don't just rely on those talismans, wooden swords, herbs, and fox tails anymore.
陈半仙：不管是马桶塞还是阿婆的假牙，你都要“物尽其中，以怪制胜”——万变不离其宗，那些符纸和木剑、羊毛草、狐狸尾……你就不要再用了。

Demi-Divine Chen: Still, you should take this protection amulet. It could save your life if things go south.
陈半仙：不过，你还是带上这个护身符，以防万一，还能保你一命。

An-an Lee: Wow, thanks, Sifu! What about Lily? I can take her too?
李安安：哇，多谢师父！那我的 Lily 嘞？我可以带上她吧?

She holds the delicate lily gently in her hand, as if holding a sleeping kitten.
她捧起了那朵仍羞涩的百合花，就像举起一只还在酣睡的小猫。

Demi-Divine Chen: Up to you, kiddo! I'll pick you up tomorrow. No, scratch that, in three days!
陈半仙：你随意啦！我明日——不，我三日后会来接你！

He holds his bandaged head as he walks, wincing and muttering to himself as he goes.
他扶着绑满了绷带的脑袋，咬着牙，嘶嘶作痛地走了。

Three days later
三日后

Demi-Divine Chen: *cough* Kiddo! Kiddo! That's strange. Where'd she go?
陈半仙：咳咳，豆丁……豆丁！奇了，人嘞?

He approaches on tiptoe, his flip-flops making a faint "pap-pap" sound on the wet ground.
他踮起脚尖，拖鞋在湿漉漉的地面上哒哒作响。

Demi-Divine Chen: Damn, kiddo. I thought you were made of stronger stuff than this. I was starting to think you could take on anything.
陈半仙：呵，死豆丁……我还以为你真是铜头铁骨，打都打不死。

Demi-Divine Chen: Well, I guess I'm still your Sifu, after all, and since I gave you that protection amulet, you should've made it out of here alive. Guess I'll show a little mercy and find the thing for ya.
陈半仙：但毕竟师徒一场，我给了护符，活要见人……我就大发慈悲，费心找下啦……

A rumbling comes from deep within the tunnel, the vibrations creating ripples on the water's surface.
隧道远方忽然传来了隆隆声响，水域上泛起了因震颤而来的波纹。

He looks up. In the distance, a swarm of ghosts rushes toward him, as if fleeing for their long-departed lives.
他抬起头，眼见远方，一群幽魂正逃荒般地朝自己涌来。

Demi-Divine Chen: ...?!
陈半仙：?!

???: Hey, it's broad daylight! Where are you all going? Isn't that just asking for trouble, running out there like that? Come on, lighten up!
???：喂，现在日光日白！你们往那里走，不是找“死”咩！别那么小气啦！

???: Come back and help me get my Tetris up and running again! It's so boring here! I promise! I promise I'll take good care of you this time!
???：返来帮我的俄罗斯方块游戏机发电啦，我好无聊啊，呜……！我保证！我保证今次会好好照顾你们噶!

Demi-Divine Chen: Where's that voice coming from?
陈半仙：哪来的声音……?

Ghost: Save ... Help me ...
鬼魂：逃@#&￥逃*￥救……超生我吧@#*!

A ragged cloth carried by the ghosts is flung over Chen's head, turning everything black.
一张破布被幽魂们刮起，直挂到他的脑门上，眼前一片漆黑。

Demi-Divine Chen: Huh? G-Get this thing off of me! It stinks!
陈半仙：唔？拿、拿走啊！臭死了!

An-an Lee: Eh? Looks like one little fishie slipped through the net! Come on, time to come to Mama, my little power-generating hamster!
李安安：咦？正好这里还有个漏网之鱼，乖乖同我返去啦！我的发电“小仓鼠”!

She lunges forward, crashing into the man wrapped in cloth, like a lion leaping on its prey.
少女飞扑过来，犹如一头雄狮压倒了被布裹住的男人。

Demi-Divine Chen: Urgh!
陈半仙：唔、唔……!

An-an Lee: Still got some fight in you, huh? Hmph, I'll teach you to be a good little fishie!
李安安：挣扎得这么犀利？哼哼，我让你不听话!

An-an Lee: Eat my invincible pork rib hammer!
李安安：食我无敌排骨大锤啦！

She raises a talisman-covered pig bone that she fished from the sewage earlier high above her head.
她举起那只从泔水中捞出来的，用记号笔画满了符咒的猪大腿骨，毫不留情地砸了过去。

Demi-Divine Chen: Ugh! An-an Lee, I've had it up to here with you!
陈半仙：唔哇……！李安安，我顶你个 X 啊！

He rips the cloth off his face as he desperately tries to avoid the impending strike.
他好不容易扯开了身上的布，慌忙躲避这避犹未及的下砸。

His backward step just happens to coincide with the cloth landing on the ground, causing him to slip.
接着，脚踩到滑溜溜的布面——

crash
“噗通”——

...
……

An-an Lee: Sifu, sorry about that. Rest easy. I'll support you by catching ghosts.
李安安：师父……对不住啊，你安心养伤啦，我去捉鬼养你。

Chen, wrapped up like a mummy, lies on the bed with one leg strung up above him.
被绑成木乃伊的病人，安详地躺卧在床，高高悬吊起了一条大腿。

He turns his face away from her, his tears and snot soaking into the pillow.
他撇过脸，闭上眼睛。鼻涕和眼泪一呛一呛的就流了出来，淌在了枕头上。

Demi-Divine Chen: My whole life's reputation down the drain in an instant. *sob* Gods above, what do I owe you? A few million? You can't wait to take my life?
陈半仙：一世英名毁于一旦，呜呜呜……老天爷，我欠你几百万咩？等不及收回我这条命。

The quiet murmurs of the nurses float in from outside the ward.
病房外传来护士们的窃窃私语。

Nurse I: Like I said, this patient you've got—I've never seen someone so respectful. He went to the cemetery last month to honor his ancestors and ended up cracking his head open on one of the graves!
护士 I：是啊……我都讲，你照顾的这个病人好有孝心噶，上个月才去墓园祭拜，把头都磕破了！

Nurse II: Seems he's always doing good deeds. This time, he ended up with a broken femur, apparently because he dove into the sewer after his grandma's dentures.
护士 II：真是多行善事啊，这次他摔了个大腿骨折，好像也是替阿婆去下水道捞假牙……

Nurse II: I guess the heavens are on his side, though. Good people get what they deserve, and he's got such a sweet girl taking care of him.
护士 II：不过也是老天有眼，好人有好报啊……有这么好一个女仔照顾他。

Demi-Divine Chen: ...
陈半仙：……

An-an Lee: Hey, Sifu, you haven't eaten in days. How about a nice apple?
李安安：你好几日没食东西了，师父……食颗苹果好不好？

She raises the peeled apple in her hands to his mouth, but his lips remain firmly sealed.
她将手中削好的苹果递过去，撞上了紧闭的唇齿。

Demi-Divine Chen: I'm gonna chew you up, I swear it! Get out of here! Look, I'll admit it now. I can't handle this kind of calamity! I ain't teaching you anymore, got it?
陈半仙：我食你**啊！快走开啦，我认衰了，你这个劫我接不住，我不教了，得不得?

Demi-Divine Chen: You think this is all fun and games still? I've already given you half my life, kiddo!
陈半仙：你是不是觉得好好玩啊？我半条命都给你啦！

Demi-Divine Chen: Get lost, ya hear me! I didn't take on a student. I took on a walking catastrophe!
陈半仙：滚出去啦！我收的不是徒，是我自己的瘟神啊！

An-an remains silent as she places the fruit basket on the bedside table.
女孩沉默不语，把慰问的水果篮放在了床边柜子上。

An-an Lee: Well, guess I'll head off now. Take care of yourself, Sifu.
李安安：那……我走先啦，你照顾好自己，师父。

Demi-Divine Chen: ...
陈半仙：……

knock-knock-knock
“咚咚咚”。

Demi-Divine Chen: What the hell do you want now?! If you're gonna go, just go!
陈半仙：又做咩啊！要滚就爽手啦！

Nurse I: Mr. Chen?
护士 I：陈先生?

The nurse enters with a tray, a slight look of surprise on her face.
护士端着托盘，在些许诧异中走了进来。

Nurse I: That girl just now asked me to bring over your liquid meal. She said you'd rather take care of yourself.
护士 I：刚才那个女孩拜托我替你把流食送过来，她说你想靠自己照顾自己。

Nurse I: I get it. Proud men like you aren't the kind to ask for help.
护士 I：我明啦，像你这样有自尊的人，本来就好怕麻烦其他人。

She bends down, wiping the tears and snot from his face.
她弯下腰擦拭着他脸上残留的涕泪。

Demi-Divine Chen: *sigh*
陈半仙：唉……

Three months later
三个月后

Demi-Divine Chen: Look, even the Bagua Mirror at the door is broken. This place definitely has some dark energy in it. It's totally cursed.
陈半仙：连门前的八卦镜都碎了一地……果真是阴煞至极的宅邸。

Demi-Divine Chen: No wonder that rich guy spent all that money. Exorcists, priests, monks—he hired them all, and still nothing worked.
陈半仙：难怪那个有钱佬花那么多钱，从中外请来那么多除灵师、驱魔人和佛陀，都无济于事……

Now free from his bandages, Chen takes a drag from his cigarette and lets out a deep sigh.
拆除了绷带的男人吮了一口香烟，长吁一口气。

An-an Lee: Hehe, this time, it's me and my master out on the hunt together! Nothing's gonna stop us! No ghost or god!
李安安：嘿嘿，今次我们师徒双龙出海，手到擒来！管他咩鬼神，都无济于事的啦！

An-an Lee: Not to mention that rich old grandpa gave us a bunch of money! Money makes the world go round, even for ghosts! Easy la!
李安安：何况那个有钱老爷爷还给了好多资金我们，有钱能使“鬼”推磨，Easy 啦～

Chen raises a hand, flicks his cigarette to the ground, and snuffs it out beneath his flip-flop.
男人拦住了跃跃欲试的女孩，把烟头碾灭了。

Demi-Divine Chen: This time, I'm going solo. You wait for me outside, kiddo.
陈半仙：今次我一个人去。你在外面等我，豆丁。

Despite the pout of disappointment on her face, she obediently steps aside.
女孩露出了失望的表情，垮下脸，但还是乖乖向后退了。

An-an Lee: Me taking care of the logistics? But, Sifu, your injury just healed. You really sure it's fine?
李安安：我做后勤？但是……师父，你的伤才好了几日，真的没事吗？

An-an Lee: Or we can swap places if you're worried I'll bring you bad luck. I can totally handle myself now!
李安安：或者，我们也可以换一换噶，如果你还怕我给你招来祸害……现在我都已经可以独当一面啦！

For the first time, he reaches out and places his palm on An-an's head.
他从未有过地摸了摸女孩的脑袋。

Demi-Divine Chen: Heh, you're a real pain in the ass, kiddo. But as a master, letting my apprentice take the lead would be like abandoning all the lessons of the past.
陈半仙：呵，你的确好乞人憎，豆丁……但是为人师表，如果让徒弟当先锋，就把祖训都丢光了。

Demi-Divine Chen: This time, I'll be wearing the Three-Clarities Bell. If you hear me ring it, pull the rope and bring me back up. If it doesn't work, you get yourself to safety.
陈半仙：这次，换我系上这个三清铃。一旦你听到我摇铃，就拉我身上这根绳，把我拉回来……如果无济于事，你就先保全自己，离开这里。

Demi-Divine Chen: Got it?
陈半仙：明白未?

An-an gives a reluctant nod.
女孩不情不愿地点了点头。

An-an Lee: Sure.
李安安：嗯……

Demi-Divine Chen: Catch you later, kiddo.
陈半仙：待会见啦，豆丁。

He quickly disappears into the darkness beyond the door.
背影消失在门扇内的黑暗之中。

Half an hour passed ... One hour passed ...
一炷香，两柱香……

The sun descends from its place high in the sky, and An-an's shadow stretches longer and longer until it has almost completely vanished.
太阳高挂又落下，女孩的影子被缓慢拉长，直到接近消失。

An-an Lee: Sifu?
李安安：师父?

She bangs on the door, but there is no answer from the other side.
她敲打沉重的门扇，但里面未传来任何回应。

An-an Lee: ...
李安安：……

Streetside Fortune Teller: Young lady, I haven't come across palm lines like these for a long, long time. You've faced many calamities already, but your life force is more resilient than a thousand-year-old tortoise. You're not like the rest of us.
街边算命师：后生女，我好久没见过这样的掌纹，看来你早早经过几场大劫，命都硬过千年龟，和我们这些凡夫俗子不是一路。

Streetside Fortune Teller: And the lily on your waist—an object of such extreme yin. Even though its moment has not yet arrived, you've managed to bring it under perfect control. I have to admit, I'm quite amazed.
街边算命师：还有你腰上挂的百合花……极阴之物，虽未到时候，但已被你制得服服帖帖，也算我开眼界啦。

Streetside Fortune Teller: My path is but a humble one. I can't do much to change your destiny.
街边算命师：我道行浅，对你的命途无能为力啊。

An-an Lee: That's not what I wanted to ask. Old man, I just wanna know, if I bring bad luck to people, if I'm their calamity, does that mean I have to stay away from them?
李安安：我不是想问这个……大叔，我想知，如果我会给人招来祸害，如果我就是他人的劫……那我是不是一定要远离那个人？

An-an Lee: Any way to, like, get rid of the bad luck I bring?
李安安：有无办法，将我给其他人带来的劫，“除”干净？

Streetside Fortune Teller: You want to change someone else's destiny? Young lady, karma will always catch up to you. No matter how strong your life force, you can't go against heaven and earth. It's best to just leave other people to their own destiny.
街边算命师：……你想改其他人的命啊？后生女，事有因果，你命再硬都不过天地……少去管其他人啦。

Streetside Fortune Teller: Besides, if you're their calamity, that means there's a karmic connection between the two of you. They're the ones who have wronged you. There's no need to bring misfortune upon yourself.
街边算命师：而且……若你是他人的劫，就说明他与你有因果，他曾对你不利。你更没必要替自己招灾。

She clutches the protection amulet in her hand and shakes her head.
她抓紧手中的护身符，摇了摇头。

An-an Lee: I've made up my mind. No matter how tough my destiny gets, I'm not running away!
李安安：我决定的，天命再坎坷，我也不会逃。

Streetside Fortune Teller: *sigh* Then, there's only one way forward.
街边算命师：唉，后生女……只有一个办法。

Streetside Fortune Teller: You'll need to stake your own life against the calamity you've drawn upon yourself. If your calamities intersect, you'll either both die or the slate will be wiped clean.
街边算命师：就是把你自己的命，也搭进你所招致的劫……劫数相交，你们要么双双殒命，要么一笔勾销。

Streetside Fortune Teller: But, if you've made up your mind, do exactly as I say. Carve a slit three cuns below the lower left section of your palm. But remember, once you do so, you must resolve your calamity before the cut heals and forms a scab.
街边算命师：若你想好了，就依照我说的来——在你掌心左下三寸的地方，以刀刃划伤一道裂口，但是一旦划开，你要趁着它愈合结痂之前，解决这场劫数。

Streetside Fortune Teller: Otherwise ...
街边算命师：否则……

He suddenly falls silent.
他不再多言语一句。

An-an Lee: ...
李安安：……

An-an stares at the nail clippers in her hand, opens the palm of her other hand, and counts one, two, three cuns with her thumb.
女孩凝视着手中的指甲刀，张开右手掌，紧紧握住了。

An-an Lee: Hang on, Sifu.
李安安：等着我，师父。

She grits her teeth and makes as deep a cut as she can bear to ensure she has the most possible time before it heals. A thick line of blood pours from the wound and drips on the ground.
为延缓愈合，刀刃割出了一个惊心触目的伤口，鲜血不住地滴落着——

"blip-blip-blip"
“滴答滴答——”

An-an Lee: *panting*
李安安：呼……

She raises her head and crawls into the partially opened, pitch-black "cave."
她抬起头，向半张开的漆黑“洞穴”里钻去。

Haunted Mansion
鬼宅

A broken mirror partially draped in a white cloth stands in the darkness, mist gently rising from its surface.
破碎的镜面被白布遮掩了一半，雾气袅袅。

Shattered exorcism tools from past practitioners have been stacked in the corner by some hidden force, creating a massive, towering heap of debris.
地面上前人遗留下的破损的除灵工具，被某种力量堆积在墙角，形成一个巨大、高耸的垃圾堆。

An-an Lee: This blood ... It's not dry yet. Is it Sifu's?
李安安：这些血迹……还没有干，是师父的?

She moves forward, tracing the twisting blood trail on the floor, weaving between the hallway to various rooms and back again.
她沿着地上的歪歪扭扭的血迹朝前走着，在走廊与房间之间穿梭。

Then, she feels her foot land on something.
忽然，脚下似乎踩到了什么。

An-an Lee: Is this Sifu's Three-Clarities Bell?
李安安：这是……师父的三清铃?

The bell has been shattered, as though it were crushed by some horrifying force.
先前坚硬的铃铛，碎成了几块，仿若被一种可怖的外力碾压过。

She crouches down to gather the fragments but quickly uncovers a more terrifying truth.
她弯腰试图捡拾起碎片，却恍然发现了另一个恐怖的真相。

An-an Lee: Wait a minute, this blood on the floor ... It wasn't here before. Is it still leaking from somewhere?
李安安：搞咩，地面上的血迹……并不是刚才流下来的，而是正在渗出来的?

An-an Lee: What's with the continuous trail of this stuff?
李安安：但是，又为什么有不间断的痕迹呢……

A spine-chilling wind sweeps in from behind.
背后传来一股令人不寒而栗的阴风。

An-an Lee: Wait, did something lure me here on purpose?
李安安：难道，是它们刻意引诱我到这里？

???: Heh-heh-heh.
???：呵、呵呵……

Blood continues to ooze from the floor, and in the mirror before her, ghostly figures begin to form.
地板渗出越来越多的鲜血，面前的镜子里，开始浮现出绰绰的鬼影。

An-an Lee: Eh! Who's that creeping up behind me?
李安安：呃……！是谁在我身后？

She turns around, only to find no one.
扭过头，身后空无一人。

An-an Lee: Sifu, where are you?! Can you hear me?!
李安安：师父，你在哪里?！能听到我的声音吗?

The lightbulb bursts, and she is left totally in the dark.
灯泡破碎，黑暗顷刻涌来。

An-an Lee: Crap, looks like I've walked right into a trap.
李安安：弊家伙，看来中圈套了……

She kneels down, spreads open a roll of blank yellow paper, and smears it with blood, chanting softly under her breath.
她跪坐下来，摊开空白的黄符纸，以血涂抹着，嘴中念念有词——

An-an Lee: "Holy yellow-robed warriors, sever these evil spirits, banish these demons."
李安安：“黄衣师兵，斩伐妖魂，馘灭千魔。”

An-an Lee: "Crush the wicked, annihilate their kind. Command the execution of evil, in accordance with the Jade Emperor's decree, to cleanse the Three Realms!"
李安安：“摧落凶奸，绝种灭类。取令枭残，玉帝上命，清荡三元!”

She knocks her teeth three, six, twelve, twenty-four—thirty-six times.
紧接着，她叩齿三次，六次——直至三十六次。

The wicked spirits scream and howl, as if the sound has pierced their eardrums, sending them writhing on the ground in agony.
一时间，宅邸内的邪祟嚎哭嘶鸣，仿若被声音穿刺了耳膜般，群群匍匐在地。

An-an Lee: Hah, hahah, looks like it's working, but why's my head so dizzy?
李安安：哈、哈哈……看来有效，不过我的头，怎么这么晕嘞……

Blood is still pouring out of her wound. It trickles down her palm and drips down to the floor.
鲜血从她的掌心往下淌着，滴落在地，

An-an Lee: Is it because I'm losing blood? But, wait, it hasn't scabbed over yet! Great! Sifu, your calamity—there's still a chance!
李安安：是失血的原因吗？不过……还没结痂，真是太好了。师父，你的劫，还有救啊!

As her head grows lighter, she loses her balance and stumbles to the floor.
她的头正在发昏，脚下已经站不住了，松垮在地。

On the walls and ceiling, arms begin to form, their deformed shapes reaching out toward her.
墙壁与天花板上，扭曲的手臂正慢慢形成，朝着失血倒地的少女伸去。

An-an Lee: *cough* Stay behind me, Lily!
李安安：咳、咳……好好躲在我身后，Lily！

Amidst the darkness, the flower bud begins to tremble.
伸手不见五指的黑暗里，花苞忽然颤抖了——

An-an Lee: An object of such extreme yin? So if I leave Lily out in the sun, will she develop wrong?
李安安：极阴之物？那我让 Lily 晒太阳，反而搞到她发育不良？

Streetside Fortune Teller: *sigh* That's right. You can't raise something like this through conventional methods. Don't listen to those old arcanists who still believe that "yin must weaken, yang must strengthen" nonsense.
街边算命师：唉，没错啦。像这样的“东西”，你不能以常人的手段去养她。不要像那帮食古不化的老神秘学家笃信“阴极必衰，阳极必盛”那一套。

Streetside Fortune Teller: "Yang is the ruler, yin the subject. The subject can never surpass the ruler."
街边算命师：“阳，君也。阴，臣也。事臣不得过君。”

Streetside Fortune Teller: "When yang rises, it dominates its yin; when yin hides and dares not reveal itself, the spirits and ghosts remain concealed."
街边算命师：“阳兴则胜其阴，阴伏不敢妄见，则鬼神藏矣。”

Streetside Fortune Teller: And this flower?
街边算命师：这朵花嘞。

Streetside Fortune Teller: Only when you reach a place where yin spirits linger ...
街边算命师：只有到了阴灵不散的地方——

"... will it bloom."
“才会盛开。”

???: ...
???: ……

The bud gradually opens up, unveiling the "stigma" at its center.
万籁寂静中，花瓣缓缓绽放，露出了中心的“花蕊”——

???: *burp*
???: 嗝……

???: $%^@&(*^%
???: 咯、咯、咯～

???: Hungry ... Hungry ...
???: 饿＃￥，好肚饿 &#……

At the center of the lily, a petite, delicate head sways happily in the wind.
那是一个小巧玲珑的脑袋，在阴风阵阵中，欢快地摇曳。

The glow from the lily surrounds her, creating a barrier that keeps the evil in the darkness at bay.
百合花散发出来的光亮将她照亮了一簇，犹如分界线般，将身后的魑魅魍魉隔绝于外。

Abated, the churning, chaotic mass whispers and shivers.
那涌动的黑、混沌的黑，忽然窃窃私语，瑟瑟发抖——

An-an Lee: You're ... Lily?
李安安：你是……Lily?

Lily: Eat, eat #*&￥ Fun, fun $%^@&(*^%
Lily: 食、食 #*&￥……好玩，咯咯咯～♫

This is a place An-an will never think to look. He feels confident about that.
……这是女孩不会料想到的地方，他对此满腹信心。

He walks out through the back door, flicking a cigarette butt under his flip-flop and stomping it out.
从后门走出来，他将烟头丢到了拖鞋底下，碾得熄灭。

He knows An-an's heart well by now.
他早已熟悉女孩的怜悯心。

Demi-Divine Chen: Thanks for taking the hit for me, kiddo. I'll burn some spirit money for you after your death.
陈半仙：豆丁，多谢你代我挡劫啦……之后我会烧纸给你的。

He steps past the spirit-summoning banners stuck by the door, waves his hand, and exits.
他跨过藏在门旁的数只招魂幡，摆摆手离开了。

Demi-Divine Chen: You see that, you blind fool? I've outsmarted destiny.
陈半仙：盲佬，我赢过命数了。

苟且与恐惧
Living in Fear GM-06

Living in Fear
苟且与恐惧

Demi-Divine Chen: The night before I left the country, I kept thinking, once I get there, I'll be able to break free from my calamity once and for all.
陈半仙：出国的前一天晚上，我一直想，到了那边，我就终于可以完全摆脱我的劫了。

Demi-Divine Chen: This time, I'll start fresh, open an exorcism agency in Los Angeles, and live a decent life—a life better than I've ever lived before.
陈半仙：这次我会白手起家，在洛杉矶开一间除灵事务所，过上与之前截然不同的体面生活。

Demi-Divine Chen: No more lying around on old newspapers, no more eating half-cooked food, no more looking in the mirror to find this stubbled face staring back at me every day. No more stinking, worn-out shirts.
陈半仙：不用再躺旧报纸，不用再食半生不熟的东西，没有胡茬，还有发臭的汗衫。

Demi-Divine Chen: I made contact with the local Paranormal Affairs Bureau over there. They'd been looking for a Chinese exorcist.
陈半仙：我同那边当地的鬼魂治理协会取得了联系，他们一直很想要一名来自中国的除灵师。

Demi-Divine Chen: But I forgot something. I forgot that when you reach a certain age, you realize that there are bigger things to fear than "ghosts."
陈半仙：但我忘了——当人老到一定程度，就会发现“鬼”只是所有恐惧的事物里，最微不足道的一个。

Street Bar
街边酒吧

Bureau Member Tony: Hahaha, no, seriously! When this Chinese guy first got here, he had a backpack full of toys and stuff, and he said he'd clear out the whole haunted house all by his damn self! Haha!
协会成员托尼：哈哈哈，你们不明白……这个中国佬刚来的时候，背包里只带了一些稀奇古怪的小玩具，就妄想一个人把那所阴宅清理干净。

Bureau Member Tony: One time, I had a spirit detector in my hand, and he asked if I was talking on the phone! I'm telling you, it's like he's crawled straight out of a cave.
协会成员托尼：我举着探灵器，他还问我是在打电话吗，活像一个从洞里刚爬出来的原始人。

He sets down his beer and waves his arms around as he mimics a caveman, causing his drinking mates to burst into laughter.
他撇下啤酒杯，伸出双手表演猴子的样子，惹得酒客们哄堂大笑。

Bureau Member Tony: Hey, Chen, come over here! Get your little wooden sword and bell, show 'em your moves!
协会成员托尼：Chen，来，别害羞。把你的木头剑和铃铛拿出来，让他们瞧瞧你的把式。

In the corner, Chen sits with his head down, his fists clenched.
角落里，埋着头格格不入的男人攥紧了拳头。

Bureau Member Ruth: Ignore him, Chen. Tony's been pickling his brain since he was old enough to drink. We all know you've got your own methods. You just need some time to prove them.
协会成员鲁特：Chen，别理他，放轻松。托尼的脑子早就喝坏掉了，我们都知道你有自己的一套法子。只是你还需要点儿时间向我们验证它。

Bureau Member Tony: Methods? You mean those "Seven-Star Steps," or whatever it's called ... Hah! Guy looks like he's trying to walk the catwalk or something! Quit yanking my chain, buddy.
协会成员托尼：法子？你是说学着那些走秀的模特，走起那个所谓的“七星禹步”，哈哈哈……别耍宝了，伙计。

Bureau Member Tony: We've given him more than enough time, years even! And the only thing he's gotten better at is making us laugh! I mean, seriously, is there anything he CAN do?
协会成员托尼：我们给他的时间也够多了，足足几年工夫了，他除了为我们找乐子的功夫有长进，还显了什么能耐？

Demi-Divine Chen: I'm leaving. See you tomorrow.
陈半仙：……我先走了，明天见。

As he stands, the others fall silent, their eyes following him as he leaves.
众人不约而同噤声了，在注视着他离开以后，转瞬——

Then, another round of laughter erupts.
又爆出了一阵笑声。

Bureau Member Tony: Ah, Ruth. I'll never get tired of seeing you try to play the good Samaritan! Cracks me up every time, hahaha!
协会成员托尼：说真的，鲁特……你爱发善心的习惯真是让我百看不厌，哈哈哈。我爱你那装作好人的样子。

Bureau Member Ruth: I'm serious, Tony. We finally got someone around who can bring a little entertainment around here, and you wanna chase him off? Besides, he makes dealing with stuff in Chinatown a hell of a lot easier.
协会成员鲁特：我是在说实话，托尼。我们好不容易有了个乡巴佬供我们取乐，你怎么能这样把他气走呢？况且有这家伙露脸，咱们在那些唐人街的地方就好办很多。

Bureau Member Ruth: You've probably heard there's a new exorcism agency in Chinatown. The St. Pavlov Foundation's already made contact with the girl who opened it—gave her the green light.
协会成员鲁特：你应该听说了，最近唐人街开张了一个除灵事务所，圣洛夫基金会已经同那个女孩接触过了，她得到了批准。

Bureau Member Ruth: Her stuff's the real deal, too. Makes Chen's stunts look even crazier. Not even the people down in Chinatown buy what he's selling anymore.
协会成员鲁特：相比起来，Chen 现在那些滑稽的除灵把戏完全抬不上台面，连那些唐人都不信这一套。

Bureau Member Tony: What's her name?
协会成员托尼：她叫什么名字?

Bureau Member Ruth: Uh, it's kinda weird. She's called—
协会成员鲁特：是个怪名字，叫作——

An-an Lee
泥鳋的士

...
……

Demi-Divine Chen: I heard the whole thing from the doorway, but I knew I had no choice. So I made my way back to my place down the street.
陈半仙：——我站在门口，听到了所有的对话，但我知道我没得选，所以我走向了街区的出租屋。

Demi-Divine Chen: The irony of this whole thing is that this might be the very reason I became an exorcist. I fear poverty way more than ghosts—I fear sickness, I fear their stares, I fear being judged, I fear disappointment—I fear people.
陈半仙：讽刺的是，或许这是我成为除灵师的原因，比起“鬼”，我更害怕贫穷，也害怕疾病，害怕他们所有人的目光，害怕被审视，害怕被失望——害怕人。

Demi-Divine Chen: I fear that if I leave the bureau, I'll be right back at square one.
陈半仙：我害怕自己如果离开协会，一切都会回归原点。

Demi-Divine Chen: I'm standing at a crossroads, knowing that if I just turn the corner, I'll be right there in Chinatown, where arcanists and humans live side by side. But still, I choose not to go.
陈半仙：我站在分岔路口，我知道我只需拐个角就能到唐人街。那里有我熟悉的神秘学家与人类共融的世界。但我不会走。

Demi-Divine Chen: Just keep moving forward—always forward—no looking back, no left or right turns.
陈半仙：只有往前，只有往前，后面不会有任何东西。

I can feel so many eyes on me—destiny looming over my head—so I don't look back. I just keep running and running.
我感到有好多双眼在看我，天命就悬在我头顶，所以我没有回头，我一直跑，一直跑——

I know she's on my tail again. I know my calamity isn't through with me yet. I've gotta keep running.
我知道她又追过来了，我的劫还没有过去，我还要继续逃。

Escape is the only way forward.
只有逃才有出路。

Don't get comfortable. Don't ever think you're safe.
别感到安全，别感到安全。

Don't indulge in pleasure. It'll make you complacent and destroy you in the end.
不要耽于愉悦，那会让你麻痹，最终摔得粉身碎骨。

Your punishment will come soon enough. Your calamity isn't over yet.
惩罚很快会来的，你的劫还没有过去。

It's just up ahead, always ahead, waiting for you to bump right into it.
它就在前面，一直在前面等你掉进去。

Don't breathe.
别喘息。

You can't breathe yet.
还不能喘息。

Demi-Divine Chen: Aahhhh!
陈半仙：啊啊啊啊啊！

Rental Home
出租屋

I woke up that night, drenched in sweat, the nightmare still fresh in my mind.
那天午夜，我大汗淋漓地从噩梦中醒来。

Then, I made my decision.
然后，我做了决定。

I had to kill An-an Lee with my own two hands.
我要亲手杀死李安安。

ring-ring-ring
“嘟、嘟——嘟。”

Demi-Divine Chen: Hey, Ruth, Tony, it's Chen. You guys got time?
陈半仙：喂，鲁特、托尼……我是 Chen，有空没?

Demi-Divine Chen: I have a way to help you clean up Chinatown. Meet me at the lighthouse tomorrow at 3 p.m.
陈半仙：关于唐人街，我有办法帮你们，明日下午三时，来灯塔找我。

非英雄，无主义
Neither Valor nor Heroism GM-07

Neither Valor nor Heroism
非英雄，无主义

She lifts her chin, finding a stubbled face and a pair of weary, sunken eyes before her.
仰起头，那是一张胡子拉碴的面孔，以及疲惫气虚的眼睛。

The man's collar is stained yellow with neck grease. As he crouches, his grimy underwear peeks out from his slouchy pants.
衣领已经被脖颈的油脂沾得发黄，蹲下来的身子露出脏兮兮的裤衩。

One hand scratches an ankle to a foot jammed in a loose and tattered flip-flop.
被蹂躏得松松垮垮的人字拖上，一只手在挠着脚踝。

An-an Lee: Sifu?!
泥鳋的士：——师父?!

Demi-Divine Chen: Looks like all that spirit money I burned was for nothing. I didn't expect you to be so ... full of life.
陈半仙：看来我烧的纸全部没鬼用啊……没想到你这么生龙活虎。

His deep, dark eye sockets are like pits, the blood vessels in his eyes like spiderwebs.
他深黑色的眼窝似是一个坑洞，眼眸里的血丝犹如蛛网。

Demi-Divine Chen: Why can't you just give me some peace, kiddo?
陈半仙：……豆丁，为什么你就不可以放过我呢?

He pulls out a chair and sits across from her, as though preparing for an interrogation.
他拎出另一张椅子，审讯般地坐在她面前。

His gaze pierces through her, like he's searching for the answer to destiny's final riddle.
目光炯炯，就像试图知晓一个命数的谜底。

Demi-Divine Chen: I've already left everything behind. Can't you just let me get on with my life? Can't you show a little mercy?
陈半仙：我背井离乡……你还不可以高抬贵手放我一条命吗?

He rips off his toupee, revealing the balding head beneath it.
他扯下头顶盖得严严实实的假发，露出秃空的脑袋。

Demi-Divine Chen: I ain't had a good night's sleep for years. My yang's all faded—a nonstop "spiritual possession" ... The doctors say my kidneys are failing, like I'm some old geezer already.
陈半仙：这几年来，我从未安眠过一次，阳气尽失，“鬼注”不停……医生都讲我的肾已经衰竭，形同一个年过花甲的老头。

Demi-Divine Chen: And now, here you are, still working against me. You followed me all the way to Chinatown just so you could nab my little slice of the pie?!
陈半仙：如今，你还处处同我作对，来唐人街同我争饭食?!

Demi-Divine Chen: Why do you have to outdo me in everything? Yeah, I've done wrong, and yeah, I created this karma, but don't you think I've been through enough?
陈半仙：为什么你做咩都要赢过我？我是造了孽，惹了你的因果——但难道我还不够惨吗?

Demi-Divine Chen: Haven't I already paid the price?!
陈半仙：我付出的代价还不够多咩?!

Demi-Divine Chen: Why is it that you could climb out of that well I could never even climb into? Why is it that you can do all the things I had to fight so hard for, and all without breaking a sweat?
陈半仙：凭什么我没有下的那口井，你就可以轻易爬出来？凭什么我要费尽力气做的事，你就能轻易做到?

An-an Lee: But, Sifu, there wasn't really anything in the well.
泥鳋的士：可是，师父……那井里头又不是什么了不得的东西。

He chuckles quietly.
他哑然失笑了。

Demi-Divine Chen: You know where 13 Holy Exorcism Techniques came from, An-an?
陈半仙：你知道《除灵十三法》的来由吗？李安安。

Demi-Divine Chen: Thirteen people. Thirteen Taoist brothers died at the bottom of that well, all for the sake of earning a living as exorcists.
陈半仙：十三人，曾经整整十三个师兄弟，为了混一口除灵的饭吃，死在那座井底。

Demi-Divine Chen: You say there's nothing in that well. You think their deaths, and mine, are nothing but a joke, right?
陈半仙：你讲那里面没有什么了不得，你讲他们的死连同我都好可笑、好卑微是不是?

Demi-Divine Chen: For years, I've lived in fear, never once enjoying a single moment of peace.
陈半仙：我为此担惊受怕几十年，从来没有一日安生。

The knife clutched in Chen's hand quivers.
男人持刀的手颤抖着。

Demi-Divine Chen: Every night, a little more of my hair falls out. Exorcism is all I have left.
陈半仙：每晚每夜，我的头发都在掉，除了除灵，我已经一无所有了。

Demi-Divine Chen: That blind fool told me you're my calamity, but all you needed to do was ring the bell, and I would've finally had peace. Peace from all this fear.
陈半仙：盲佬讲你是我的劫，你明明只要摇铃就好了……我就可以安逸了，我可以不用再惊。

Demi-Divine Chen: Then, seeing you come out of that well without so much as a scratch, I couldn't stand it. "Why?" I thought, "Why is this happening to me?!"
陈半仙：直到看到你毫发无伤地从井底出来，我不甘心，凭什么，凭什么呢?!

Demi-Divine Chen: How could someone like you just step over the bodies of my brothers like that and tell me how easy it all was?
陈半仙：为什么有人可以踩在我师兄弟的尸骸上，走到我面前说一切好轻易呢?

Demi-Divine Chen: Why does a little kid like you get to surpass me? Is this really my destiny?
陈半仙：为什么一个豆丁可以踩在我的头上呢？命数如此吗?

An-an Lee: But ...
泥鳐的士：但是……

An-an, her arms bound, looks bewildered.
被绑起来的女孩，反而露出了疑惑的表情。

An-an Lee: Sifu, if something's hard to do, does that make it something to be proud of?
泥鳐的士：师父……不轻易，难道是一种荣耀啊?

An-an Lee: Just because I got out of the well doesn't mean I have to look all sad and gloomy. I'm not gonna do that!
泥鳐的士：爬出井底的人，就一定要摆着一张臭脸，愁容满面咩？我才不要嘞。

Demi-Divine Chen: An-an, you're more ghoulish than any ghost out there. You're not even human.
陈半仙：你比鬼，更似鬼啊，李安安……你无人性啊。

An-an Lee: I don't care how many people didn't make it out of your well. It has nothing to do with me.
泥鳐的士：我才不在乎你们井底有多少人爬不上来，我也没必要负那些罪责——

An-an Lee: I'm just trying to get paid. I'm not gonna walk around like I'm some big deal.
泥鳐的士：挣钱罢了，我才不要那么高看自己嘞。

An-an Lee: I don't have any big dreams, and all that "may the peace be with us" crap? Not interested.
泥鳐的士：我又没什么又大又宏伟的志向，对“愿和平与我们同在”的理想一点都没兴趣。

An-an Lee: I don't wanna bother with learning Kung Fu or whatever. I'm just gonna take the easiest, happiest, and most fun road.
泥鳐的士：我才不想练咩童子功，哪条路又容易又简单，happy 又好玩，我就要走。

An-an Lee: Sifu, you keep saying that you've never been down to the bottom of the well, but I think you've got it wrong.
泥鳐的士：师父……你一直讲你从未下过井底，但是我觉得你讲错了。

She shakes her head, slipping her hands through the rope.
少女摇了摇头，双手从绳索中挣脱而出。

Lily peeks out from behind her, its tongue sticking out.
她的身后，露出了吐着舌头的百合花。

Lily: $%^@&(*^%
Lily: 咯咯咯～♫

Chen recoils in terror, his chair tilting back and sending him crashing to the ground. The knife slips out of his hand and slides to An-an's feet.
椅子上的男人惶恐地后撤一步，人仰马翻在地上，刀子滑落在她脚下。

Demi-Divine Chen: What the ...?!
陈半仙：这是?!

An-an gets up, stretching lazily.
站起来的女孩，伸了个懒腰。

An-an Lee: Turns out, I still prefer exorcisms, and I'm not a fan of making enemies. Tsk, tsk, Sifu. Why'd you have to make this so hard?
泥鳐的士：果然……我还是中意除灵，我不中意同人为敌，啧啧，好麻烦啊，师父。

An-an Lee: Ghosts—those balls of energy—they don't explain why they do what they do. It's just that when people die, their spirits stay frozen in that moment.
泥鳐的士：鬼魂，那些能量，从来不会讲他们为什么要这样做，当活人死了，鬼魂就只会定格在了那一个瞬间。

An-an Lee: *sigh* Pesky spirits, they don't care about right or wrong.
泥鳐的士：唉，那些骚灵邪恶又纯粹，才没有那么多是非。

An-an Lee: Sifu, you think you've never been to the bottom of the well, but you've been down there all this time, haven't you?
泥鳐的士：师父，你自以为从没有下过井……但是，其实你一直都待在井底不是吗?

An-an Lee: Your fear is "fear" itself. From the moment you decided not to go down into the well, it took root in your heart.
泥鳐的士：你的恐惧，就是“恐惧”本身啊……从你没有下井的那一刻开始，它就在你心底埋下了根。

An-an Lee: You always call me your calamity, but when I was busy clearing your karma for you, you were the one who ran away.
泥鳐的士：你总是讲我是你的劫……但你知道吗？在我替你破劫的时候，是你自己逃开了。

Her expression turns somber.
她的表情黯淡了。

Demi-Divine Chen: You're full of it! I-I don't believe you. I don't believe a word of it! You think I'm stupid?
陈半仙：你一定在讲大话！我不信……我不信，你当我是傻仔吗?

This new information and his lingering sense of morality make him hesitate.
从未知晓的信息，残存的道德令他迟疑了。

Demi-Divine Chen: You're gonna help me with my calamity? Hahaha, even ghosts wouldn't believe that, An-an!
陈半仙：你会替我破劫？哈哈哈，连鬼都不信啊，李安安！

An-an Lee: From the very start, it was your fear that made all this happen.
泥鳐的士：从始至终，都是你自己的恐惧导致了这一切。

An-an Lee: But I can't be bothered to explain, Sifu. I don't get your fear, just like I'll never understand why I should feel guilty for doing the things I do so easily.
泥鳐的士：但我好懒得跟你讲道理，师父……因为我不明白你所谓的恐惧的重量，正如我永远也不理解为什么我要为自己轻易解决事情而感到愧疚。

She scratches her head in frustration. This is already more than she's willing to deal with.
她烦恼地挠了挠头，这对她来说已是太过费神的难题。

An-an Lee: So, all I know for sure is you've gotten this far.
泥鳐的士：所以，我唯一知道的是，你已经走到了这里。

An-an Lee: If you're really suffering, if you're really struggling ...
泥鳐的士：如果你真的好痛苦，如果你真的好难受……

She sends the knife flying toward him with a kick.
她把刀子踢了过去。

An-an Lee: Sifu, you've always wanted to get rid of me, right? You think I'm your calamity and that me being around is the reason why things aren't working out for you.
泥鰼的士：师父，你不是一直想除掉我吗？你觉得我是你的劫，是因为有我的存在你才过得好不如意。

An-an Lee: I'm your fear, aren't I?
泥鰼的士：我，就是你的恐惧，对吧?

He can't deny it. He picks up the knife.
男人不置可否，捡拾起了刀。

An-an Lee: Well then, go ahead, take me out. Don't chicken out now, Sifu.
泥鰼的士：那么，来除掉我啦……师父，不要再临阵退缩了。

An-an Lee: Don't fall for those grand speeches and empty gestures. Don't be scared anymore.
泥鰼的士：不要被那些冠冕堂皇的、好正义的做派和说辞讲服，不要再惊啦。

An-an Lee: People will always talk about what's right and wrong, but if you don't listen to them, you don't have to worry about it.
泥鰼的士：是非成日有，唔听自然无。

An-an Lee: I'm not one of those psychology geeks at Laplace. I don't understand what you're going through, and I can't feel what you're feeling. So get rid of me.
泥鰼的士：把我除掉。因为我不懂你的痛苦，也不会理解你的心情，我又不是拉普拉斯的那帮心理学书虫。

An-an Lee: Or are you gonna keep running? Are my words gonna make you hesitate again? If you do, I'll call the Foundation to come catch you. I am a model citizen after all, hahaha!
泥鰼的士：还是说，你要继续逃跑嘞？要因为我的话，动摇咩？我会 call 基金会的那帮差佬，把你捉回去噢……毕竟我是三好市民啦，哈哈哈哈。

An-an Lee: You can't make a cow drink water if it refuses to lower its head.
泥鰼的士：牛唔饮水唔揿得牛头低……

Her eyes flash with a sudden intensity.
她的眼神倏忽间凌厉了。

An-an Lee: Don't try to make up with your so-called idea of justice, Sifu.
泥鰼的士：不要试图和所谓的正义和解，师父。

An-an Lee: Just keep doing your thing.
泥鰼的士：继续做你应该做的事吧。

He is momentarily stunned, then sighs, realizing how light the knife feels in his hand.
他怔住了，旋即吐了一口气，感觉手上的刀子这样轻盈。

Demi-Divine Chen: Heh, you really are one strange kid.
陈半仙：……呵，你真是个怪胎。

Demi-Divine Chen: Still ...
陈半仙：不过……

Demi-Divine Chen: You've done me a solid.
陈半仙：你帮了我个大忙。

He digs the blade into his palm, blood trickling between his fingers.
刃在手掌心割过，鲜血顺着指缝流出。

It falls onto the yellow talismans placed on the ground.
旋即——滴落在地面布置好的黄符之上。

An-an Lee: More soul summoning, Sifu? So old-school. Don't worry. I'll catch a couple of them—might be just enough to cover the electricity bill for the fridge!
泥鳐的士：……又是招魂咩，师父？好老套的戏法啊……来一对我捉一双，正好捉来交家里冰箱电费嘞！

Demi-Divine Chen: *cough*
陈半仙：咳咳咳……

He falls to his knees, his hand clasped to his mouth, but a grayish-green slime forces its way out through his fingers nonetheless.
他四肢跪地，手掌捂住嘴，青灰色的粘液却从嘴里呕出。

An-an Lee: No, that wasn't a soul summoning. Soul guidance?! Sifu, keep doing this and you'll shorten your life!
泥鳐的士：不，不对，不是招魂……是引魂?！师父，你这样……会折自己的寿啊！

Her panic makes her hesitate.
慌乱令她犹豫了。

Demi-Divine Chen: Heh heh.
陈半仙：呵呵……

He wipes the slime from his mouth without the slightest sign of hesitation.
他抹干净嘴边的污秽，毫无迟疑。

Demi-Divine Chen: You ready, kiddo?
陈半仙：豆丁，准备好没?

An-an Lee: Sifu, you already had it all figured out, huh? In too deep to back out now?
泥鳐的士：师父……路过半，桥过河，你早就打算好了?

An-an Lee: *panting*
泥鳐的士：呼……

She lets out a deep breath.
她深吐了一口气。

Then, a wide, carefree smile forms on her face, just as it did the first time he saw her.
接着，那是一抹大大咧咧的笑意，从他第一眼见到她，直到现在也从未改变过。

An-an Lee: Action!
泥鳐的士：Action！

An-an Lee: Neo-Science Exorcism Office, action!
泥鳐的士：新科学除灵驱鬼事务所，接单！

算尽
Didn't See That Coming GM-08

Didn't See That Coming
算尽

Joint Committee of SF
基金会办公室

Horropedia: We spoke to the other two members of the Paranormal Affairs Bureau, and they've confirmed that they were part of the trap your Sifu set up. He brought them in to force you out of Chinatown.
恐怖通：另外两个协会的成员，已经核查过了，他们是你师父诱饵的一部分。为了把你从唐人街赶走，才加入了这个计划。

Horropedia: Also, the staff handling the case report has made it clear that they disapprove of your actions. They say you should've taken persuasive measures rather than escalating the conflict.
恐怖通：还有，那些审理事件报告的职员，对你没有采取说服手段，引起激烈冲突的行动颇有微词。

Horropedia: Regardless, those three troublemakers are down at the police station now, thanks to your help. Although, I have to say, it took me some time to convince them to go there willingly.
恐怖通：不过，毕竟这三个始作俑者都是托你的帮助才送进了警局，我花了点时间说服了他们。

An-an Lee: Tch ...
泥鳐的士：切……

She rolls her eyes.
她翻了个白眼。

An-an Lee: So, where's my reward for handling the case? You guys better not go back on your word!
泥鳐的士：那今次我解决事件的报酬嘞？你们不会讲话不算数吧！

An-an Lee: And don't go thinking you'll get a discount! Not raising my prices is already enough of a special offer for my regulars!
泥鳐的士：别指望有折头啊！过年没抬价已经是老熟客的超级优惠了！

She tilts her head, a dark shadow falling on her face as she glares at him like an angry ghost.
她的脸垮得越来越厉害，怨鬼般瞪着对方。

Horropedia: Here.
恐怖通：接着。

An-an Lee: ...?!
泥鳐的士：?!

A hefty red packet is dropped into her hands.
一叠厚厚的红色信封丢到了她的手中。

Horropedia: Madam Z told me that this is a custom where you're from. The logistics department didn't have a clue about this "red packet," so it took me a while to track it down myself.
恐怖通：我听 Z 女士说过这是你们那边的礼仪，后勤部没有采购过那个称作“红包”的东西，我花了点时间才找到这种红色的信封。

The shadow lifts, and a golden light flashes in her eyes.
阴影一扫而空，女孩的眼中顿时冒出了金光。

She hooks her arm around his shoulders as though they're old friends.
她一手钩住了男孩，仿若过命的交情。

An-an Lee: Wow, no need to be so polite with me! Thanks so much, boss! Hehe, I wish everyone at the St. Pavlov Foundation fortune and success in everything!
泥鳐的士：哇，不用这么客气啦！多谢晒啊老板！嘿嘿，祝你们圣洛夫基金会——招财进宝、万事如意啦！

An-an Lee: Any of you at the Foundation can visit whenever you want! Especially Madam Z. I hope she comes over for tea when she's free!
泥鳐的士：我还是好欢迎圣洛夫基金会的各位大驾光临，莅临指导的！特别是你们那个 Z 女士啦，得闲过来饮茶啊！

As she speaks, she turns and cracks open the red packet, taking a sneaky peek before slipping it into her pocket, relieved.
她边说着，扭头打开信封，鬼鬼祟祟地瞥了一眼，这才放心地塞进了口袋里。

An-an Lee: Horropedia, whatever you need, you can count on the Neo-Science Exorcism Office to come through for you!
泥鳐的士：恐怖通老兄，不管有咩吩咐！我新科学除灵驱鬼事务所一定一呼百应。

Horropedia: Oh, that reminds me! There are a few things I need you to clear up.
恐怖通：噢，谢谢提醒！我确实有一些问题需要你的解答。

An-an Lee: Huh? I was just being polite. Something seriously up already?
泥鳐的士：什么……我明明只是客套而已啦……你还真有问题啊。

She turns her head and mutters quietly to herself.
少女背过头喃喃低语。

Horropedia: I've heard that, where you come from, master-apprentice loyalty is key—"Once a master, always a father," right? But you sent your own Sifu to jail, and you seem totally fine with it.
恐怖通：我听说在你们那里，师徒情谊是很重要的事——叫什么“一日为师，终身为父”？但明明是亲手把师父送进监狱，你看上去似乎并不难受。

An-an Lee: Hah. You've got me with that one.
泥鳐的士：挺上道的嘛，老兄。

Horropedia: Oh, I'm not judging you. This is my own personal curiosity speaking.
恐怖通：噢，我对在道德上谴责你不感兴趣，这只是出于个人角度的好奇。

Her smile vanishes.
少女的笑容收敛了。

An-an Lee: I think it's because he finally said thank you—that scruffy Sifu who only ever saw me as a calamity.
泥鳐的士：我想，是因为他最后向我道谢了吧，那个胡子拉碴，把我视作祸害的师父。

An-an Lee: He told me—
泥鳐的士：他同我讲——

An-an Lee: "Thank you for pulling me out of the well, kiddo."
泥鳐的士：“多谢你把我从井底拉出来，豆丁。”

An-an Lee: I think, deep down, he was actually happy too.
泥鳐的士：我就觉得，其实他也好开心。

An-an Lee: Geez, all this sappy stuff in broad daylight is so cringey, boss!
泥鳐的士：哎呀，日光日白这么煽情，丑死人了，大佬！

Horropedia: You've lost me a bit. What do you mean by the "bottom of the well"?
恐怖通：什么？井底是什么意思？我没有听明白……

She waves the question off and turns to leave.
她摆了摆手，没有管他的话，自顾自地离去了。

An-an Lee: Figure it out yourself, buddy! I'm out of here!
泥鳐的士：自己顿悟啦，老兄！我该走啦！

Horropedia: ……
恐怖通：……

Horropedia: Hang on, why do I get the feeling I've forgotten something?
恐怖通：说起来，我怎么总感觉忘了什么？

Hallway, Foundation
基金会走廊

An-an Lee: Hmm ... Hmm ... ♫
泥鳐的士：哼～哼♫

An-an's brisk pace stands in stark contrast to that of the overworked Foundation staff.
女孩轻快的步伐，在忙得焦头烂额的职员之中，显得格外瞩目。

Marcus: ...!
马库斯：……！

Marcus: Oh, she's from the same place as Madam Z.
马库斯：这是和 Z 女士来自同一个地方的人……

Marcus: *deep breath* Breathe, Marcus. It's just like any other conversation.
马库斯：呼……呼，放轻松，马库斯，就像平常那样！

She musters her courage and stands in front of An-an Lee.
她鼓起勇气，挡在了泥鳐的士前面。

An-an Lee: Huh? What's up, pretty lady?
泥鳐的士：嗯？做咩啊，靓女。

Marcus: K-Kung Hei Fat Choi!
马库斯：恭、恭喜发财！

An-an Lee: ...
泥鳐的士：……

An-an Lee: For real? Who taught you that?
泥鳐的士：不是吧，谁教你的啊！

An-an moves back a step. The unexpected greeting is like an ambush, the kind that breaks empty-pocketed adults into a cold sweat.
泥鳐的士向后退了一步，突然的拜年犹如夜袭，向来能令口袋窘迫的大人手足无措。

An-an Lee: Hmph, anyway, you shouldn't be saying that to me. I'm not old enough to be giving out red packets yet! You chose the wrong girl!
泥鳐的士：哼，不过，你、你失算了吧！我还未到要给你发红包的年纪！你挑错对象啦！

Marcus: ...?
马库斯：……？

Her gaze carries a pure innocence. Her large, confused eyes glimmer like those of an abandoned critter peering out from a cardboard box.
她的目光如此澄澈，就像是一只躲在纸箱里的弃养魔精，瞪着豆大而又困惑的眼睛。

An-an tries to ignore them, but they have already taken effect.
泥鳐的士尽量撇过脸，试图回避，却终于熬不住那双眼，缴械投降了。

An-an Lee: Oh, fine!
泥鳐的士：……算啦！

An-an Lee: Kung Hei Fat Choi!
泥鳐的士：恭喜发财啦！

She reluctantly pulls a bill from the red packet and solemnly hands it over to Marcus.
她不情不愿，从信封里抽出一张钞票，郑重地递交到马库斯的手中。

An-an Lee: That's all I'm giving you, got it? Not a single penny more!
泥鳐的士：就只有这些啦，不会再多给了！

She scurries away as if escaping a tiger's den, leaving a cloud of dust in her wake.
仿若是落入了虎穴之中，她逃窜起来卷起一阵烟尘。

Marcus remains frozen in place, unsure of what just happened.
徒留下，在原地不知所措的女孩。

Marcus: ...
马库斯：……

Marcus: Erm ... What?!
马库斯：呃……诶？诶?！

...
……

Amid sorrowful cries in the hallway, there is a rhythmic thumping sound.
走廊中，一阵阵低沉的哀鸣，以及捶打声回荡。

The residents are huddled together, whispering among themselves.
居民聚集起来，窃窃私语。

Tenant I: I told you. Ever since that girl disappeared, this place has been cursed. Just listen to that noise.
租客：我就讲嘛……自从那个女孩失踪以后，这个屋子里就好不吉利，所以才会传出这样的声音……

Tenant II: I heard the landlady got so spooked by the ghost inside that she lost her mind. That's why she hasn't been around to collect the rent in a while.
租客 II：听说包租婆都被吓得神志不清，所以这两天才没有看见她过来收租……

Tenant I: Hey, well, that's alright, then! No landlady, no rent!
租客：唉！少讲一句啦！多亏里面那只鬼把包租婆吓跑，不然过年又要找我们涨租。

He lights the spirit money in his hand and offers several bows to the "ghost."
他点燃纸钞，连连拜了几拜。

Tenant I: Thanks for the favor, ghost buddy! You just stay put, and we'll keep you well-fed and as comfortable as we can.
租客：鬼老兄，多谢帮忙啦！你好好待在里面，我们会好吃好喝供着你的。

Leisurely footsteps echo from afar, accompanied by a casual whistling.
远处传来了悠然的口哨，以及脚步声。

An-an Lee: Huh? What's with all the commotion today? Ah! Looks like we've got some new business coming our way!
泥鳐的士：嗯？今天这么热闹！看来有生意上门啦！

An-an Lee: The Neo-Science Exorcism Office, action!
泥鳐的士：新科学除灵驱鬼事务所，开张！